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Delhi Budget to have key initiatives for women, girls: CM Rekha Gupta



NATION: PG 5

Charges of 'horse trading' fly after cross-voting in Rajya Sabha polls



FILM: PG 14

Hrithik teams up with Prime Video for 'Mess'

PM Modi, UAE President discuss West Asia crisis, Strait of Hormuz security

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday held a telephone conversation with UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan to discuss the evolving situation in West Asia, with both leaders agreeing on the need to ensure safe and uninterrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz.

During the call, Modi conveyed advance Eid greetings and expressed concern over recent developments in the region. He condemned attacks on the United Arab Emirates that have led to civilian casualties and damage to infrastructure. In a post on X, Modi said, "Spoke with my brother HH Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, President of the UAE and conveyed advance Eid greetings."

He added that the two leaders reviewed the regional situation and reiterated India's position against violence targeting civilians. "Reiterated India's strong condemnation of all attacks on the UAE that have resulted in loss of innocent lives and damage to civilian infrastructure," he said.

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Essential that children have access to nutritious food, quality education

President Droupadi Murmu

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Govt withdraws Jan Vishwas amendment Bill from LS

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday withdrew a Bill from the Lok Sabha which seeks to amend certain enactments for decriminalising and rationalising offences to further enhance trust-based governance.

Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal withdrew The Jan Vishwas (Amendment Of Provisions) Bill, 2025, as reported by Select Committee after seeking permission of the House.

The Bill would be reintroduced after incorporating recommendations of the Lok Sabha select committee, officials said later. While a pending Bill can be withdrawn after seeking permission of the House, a law can be repealed by bringing a repealing Bill.

MPOST

Ukraine protests arrest of 6 citizens

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India's arrest of seven foreign nationals on terror-related charges has triggered a diplomatic row, with Ukraine formally protesting the detention of six of its citizens and seeking their immediate release and consular access, even as Indian agencies pursue an investigation into alleged cross-border militant links and illegal arms support.

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) last week detained the group, which includes one American and six Ukrainians, under provisions of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. Officials allege the accused were involved in facilitating insurgent activities by routing drones and providing training to armed groups operating in Myanmar, some of which have links to banned organisations in India. An FIR registered on Friday accuses them of conspiring to carry out terror operations and assisting ethnic armed organisations with

Continued on P4

Centre monitors LPG supply, states set up control rooms

LPG WOES PERSIST; HOUSEHOLDS, HOTELS, BUSINESSES FACE DELAYS, PANIC BOOKINGS SURGE

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The LPG supply woes continue to pose hardships to the public as well as impacting hotels, businesses and household consumers through longer waiting periods and panic bookings. The Centre has asked states to expedite approvals for piped gas projects to enable faster roll-out and ease pressure on cooking gas availability.

Officials stated that LPG supply continues to be closely monitored amid the ongoing geopolitical situation, during an inter-ministerial briefing. No shortages have been reported at LPG distributorships. Domestic LPG production from refineries has increased by around 38 per cent, and online bookings have risen to approximately 94 per cent.

The Delivery Authentication Code coverage has expanded from 53 per cent before the crisis to about 76 per cent to prevent diversion. Domestic cylinder deliveries are proceeding normally. Several States and Union Territories, including Bihar, Delhi, Gujarat, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Manipur, Rajasthan, and Uttarakhand, have issued orders for non-domestic LPG allocation as per government guidelines, ensuring commercial LPG supply across the country.

As the war in West Asia, which blocked India's access to almost 60 per cent of its LPG, continues with no end in sight, the government is now pushing for the use of alternative cooking mediums



A child sits over an empty LPG cooking gas cylinder, as people arrive to avail refilled ones, amid a shortage linked to the ongoing West Asia conflict affecting the global energy supply chain, in Prayagraj, on Tuesday

PTI

TAKEAWAYS

» Centre asks states to fast-track piped gas approvals to ease LPG pressure

» Government says no shortages at LPG distributorships despite crisis



» DOMESTIC LPG DELIVERIES PROCEEDING NORMALLY ACROSS THE COUNTRY

» Domestic LPG production up about 38%; supply closely monitored

» Online LPG bookings rise to around 94% amid demand spike

» Delivery Authentication Code coverage expanded from 53% to 76%

like induction cookers.

"Situation remains a matter of concern, but we are providing supplies as before to the domestic

consumers," said Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

This was made possible as

refineries were asked to ramp up domestic output, which was then prioritised for household kitchens. Commercial use of LPG, such as in hotels and restaurants, was initially curtailed, but later restored to a fifth of their normal offtake. "We have to look at alternatives," she said at a media briefing.

She said panic bookings for a refill LPG cylinder peaked to 87.7 lakh on March 13, but have since eased, with about 70 lakh bookings being done on Monday. This compares to about 55 lakh bookings in pre-war days.

LPG deliveries have kept pace. "We delivered 62.5 lakh cylinders on March 13 then 60 lakh on March 14..."

Continued on P4

Iran strikes UAE oil facility as Gulf tensions threaten energy supply

Israel says 2 top Iranian officials killed in airstrikes

DUBAI: Iran intensified its campaign against energy infrastructure and regional shipping routes on Tuesday, launching fresh strikes that underscored growing risks to global oil supplies and security across the Gulf.

A drone attack struck an oil facility in Fujairah on the United Arab Emirates' eastern coast along the Gulf of Oman, an area that has been repeatedly targeted in recent weeks. State news agency WAM reported that no injuries were caused by the blast. However, Emirati authorities said a man was killed by falling debris from a missile intercepted over Abu Dhabi, bringing the death toll in the UAE since the conflict began to eight.

The latest strikes come amid escalating hostilities following the February 28 launch of mili-



A man photographs a building damaged by an Israeli airstrike in Dahiyeh, Beirut's southern suburbs, Lebanon, on Tuesday

AP/PTI

tary action against Iran by the United States and Israel. Early Tuesday, a tanker anchored off Fujairah was also hit, one of roughly 20 vessels targeted since the war began, highlighting the vulnerability of maritime routes

near the Strait of Hormuz.

Iranian parliamentary speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf defended the continued attacks, saying Tehran had little choice but to respond to ongoing strikes.

Continued on P4

LS revokes suspension of 8 MPs

Calls for orderly conduct in House

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: The Lok Sabha on Tuesday lifted the suspension of eight opposition Members of Parliament with immediate effect, ending a disciplinary action that had barred them from attending proceedings since February 3 over alleged "unruly" conduct. The move followed appeals from opposition leaders and a broader agreement across party lines to ensure smoother functioning of the House.

Speaker Om Birla, while announcing the decision, reiterated the need to maintain decorum in Parliament. He said members must refrain from displaying placards, posters, photographs or AI-generated images within the House or across the Parliament complex. He noted that there was consensus among members that proceedings in the world's largest democracy should run without disruption and with collective cooperation.

The revocation came after Congress leader K Suresh urged the



MPs protest near Mahatma Gandhi statue in the Parliament premises

PTI

House to reconsider the suspension, describing the earlier developments as "regrettable" and assuring that his party would support orderly conduct going forward. His appeal received backing from several opposition figures.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju responded by underlining the importance of drawing a "Laxman Rekha" to guide conduct in the House, a

Continued on P4

OVER 400 DEAD

India condemns Pak's 'barbaric' airstrike on Kabul rehab centre

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday issued a sharp condemnation of Pakistan following an airstrike on a drug treatment facility in Kabul that reportedly killed more than 400 people and injured over 250 others, according to Afghan media reports.

In a strongly worded statement, the Ministry of External Affairs described the strike as "barbaric" and "unequivocally" denounced the attack on the Omid Addiction Treatment hospital. "This is a cowardly and unconscionable act of violence that has claimed the lives of a large

Continued on P4

JUMPING JOY



Government primary school children participate in a sack race at Hiremagalur, in Chikkamagaluru district of Karnataka, on Tuesday

PTI

LOCALS WARN OF IGNORED RISKS

Roop Nagar: Woman killed as ‘unsafe’ bridge collapses

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 60-foot iron bridge over a drain in north Delhi's Roop Nagar area collapsed on Tuesday morning, killing a woman and narrowly averting a larger tragedy, officials and residents said.

Police said the bridge, which connected Gur Mandi to Roop Nagar, had earlier been declared unsafe and closed for public movement with barricades in place. Despite this, it continued to be used regularly by locals due to the lack of a convenient alternative route.

A PCR call regarding the collapse was received at around 9.28 am, following which police and emergency teams rushed to the spot. The structure had fallen into the drain below. Rescue personnel later recovered the body of a woman, believed to be around 50 years old, who



Rescue op underway after a foot overbridge collapsed in Roop Nagar PTI

was reportedly sitting near one end of the bridge at the time. Police said efforts are underway to ascertain her identity.

Personnel from the Delhi Fire Service, National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) and Delhi Police carried out coordinated rescue operations. Multi-

ple fire tenders were deployed, and the area was cordoned off. An NDRF official said the drain had a strong current and divers were being readied, but a team from the Delhi Boat Club retrieved the body before they could be deployed.

Officials said the bridge fell

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Personnel from the Delhi Fire Service, NDRF and Delhi Police carried out coordinated rescue operations. Multiple fire tenders were deployed, and the area was cordoned off
- » 'Bridge fell under the irrigation and flood control dept, had been declared unsafe earlier'

under the irrigation and flood control department and had been declared unsafe earlier.

Residents said the timing of the collapse likely prevented a far more serious incident. The bridge serves as a key link for at least four nearby government schools, and hundreds of stu-

dents cross it every morning between 7 am and 8.30 am.

"Most students had already crossed by the time it collapsed. Had it been earlier, the consequences could have been very deadly," a local resident said.

Locals and students said warnings were often ignored as the bridge reduced travel time by nearly 30 minutes and shortened the distance by about a kilometre. Many described the structure as visibly unsafe.

"It used to wobble when we stood on it. A portion had sunk and tilted, and the railing mesh was broken," said Zoya, a Class 8 student.

Residents have demanded the immediate construction of a safer alternative route. Authorities said a detailed inspection will be carried out to determine the exact cause of the collapse, and further action will follow.

40-year-old man fatally stabbed; 4 apprehended

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 40-year-old man was allegedly stabbed to death in outer Delhi's Sultanpuri area after he refused to give money to the accused, police said on Tuesday.

A scuffle broke out between the victim, Rajinder, and the accused, two men and two minors, in a park, they said.

"The accused initially asked the victim for money, which he said he did not have. They then demanded his mobile phone, but when he refused, they became enraged. One of the accused stabbed him, and during the scuffle, one of the assailants also sustained minor injuries," a senior police officer said.

The incident came to light after a call was received from Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital regarding a medico-legal case of a man, they said.

The police said Rajinder, a resident of Sultanpuri, was admitted to the hospital with stab injuries, but succumbed during treatment. Following his death, a case of murder was



“One of the accused stabbed him, and during the scuffle, one of the assailants also sustained minor injuries”

registered under relevant provisions of the BNS, a senior police officer said.

The police said they have detained two men -- Raj (23) from Rattan Vihar, who is currently under treatment at Safdarjung hospital and Karan (23) of Sultanpuri -- and apprehended two minors in connection with the case.

Further investigation in the case is in progress.

Porters at Kashmiri Gate ISBT seek revision of rates

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The inter-state bus terminal (ISBT) porters' union on Tuesday wrote to the Delhi government seeking fixation of rates and demanding a set of welfare measures.

In a letter submitted on Tuesday, the Porters Union put forth a set of demands, saying their concerns have remained unresolved despite repeated appeals.

According to the letter, a key demand is fixation and regulation of porter rates.

"The rates that were fixed 32 years ago are still being followed today; keeping in mind the inflation, porter rates should be revised officially," the letter read.

The union also sought identity cards for porters working at ISBTs, saying this would help regulate the workforce and prevent unauthorised people from entering the trade.

Another key demand is access to basic welfare measures. In the letter, the porters' body demanded provision of benefits such as insurance and pensions, pointing out that most persons associated with the profession have no social security despite years of work.

The union also flagged "dire conditions" at the porter waiting room and lavatory in ISBT Kashmiri Gate, emphasising need for immediate attention. "The roof leaks during rain. The lavatory is unusable and uncleared waste is inviting diseases. It needs urgent cleaning," the letter stated.

Union president Sunil Ale-dia said the Rs 10 per month license fee has remained unchanged since 1990. He claimed that porter rates have remained Rs 2-4 per 40 kg since 2002-03, demanding these rates be revised.

Three arrested for posing as officials & robbing railway passenger in auto

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Three members of a robbery gang, including an auto-rickshaw driver who posed as a government official, have been arrested by the Delhi Police's Central District team, officials said.

The case came to light on March 12 after a PCR call reported a robbery involving passengers in an auto near Tagore Road Cut, close to Minto Road. The complaint was received at Kamla Market Police Station.

The accused have been

identified as Krishan Kumar (50), a resident of Fatehpur Beri; Ravi Kumar (50), a resident of Agra, Uttar Pradesh; and Rahul Gupta (32), a resident of Fatehpur Beri, Delhi.

According to police, the victim had arrived at New Delhi Railway Station from Darbhanga and was waiting for transport when he was approached by the accused and boarded their TSR auto-rickshaw.

During the journey, one of the accused allegedly impersonated a government official and conducted a fake "security verification". Under this

pretext, the victim's cash and debit card were taken. He was then handed an envelope, which the accused claimed contained his belongings.

The victim later discovered that his cash and State Bank of India debit card had been stolen, and Rs 52,000 had been fraudulently withdrawn from his bank account.

An FIR was registered, and a dedicated police team launched an investigation. By analysing CCTV footage from multiple locations, officers traced the TSR used in the crime, despite its partially concealed

registration number.

This led to a raid in Asola, Fatehpur Beri, where the three accused were apprehended.

Police said they have recovered Rs 12,500 in cash, the victim's debit card, and the auto-rickshaw used in the offence.

During interrogation, the accused allegedly confessed to targeting passengers near railway stations using deception. They would use duplicate ATM cards and exploit delays in detection to withdraw money from victims' accounts. Further investigation is underway.

Police seize 62 LPG cylinders, arrest 1 in Jamia Nagar racket

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested a 28-year-old man for allegedly running an illegal trade in LPG cylinders in the Jamia Nagar area, recovering 62 cylinders from his possession, officials said.

Acting on a tip-off received at Jamia Nagar Police Station, a police team apprehended the accused, identified as Shahnawaz, a resident of Joga Bai Extension, during routine patrolling on March 16.

Police said 62 LPG cylinders — 48 filled and 14 empty — were recovered from a Tata Ace vehicle being used to transport and sell the cylinders illegally in the

locality. The accused was unable to produce any valid licence or authorisation for the sale or transportation of LPG cylinders, prompting a detailed inspection.

During preliminary enquiry, it was found that Shahnawaz had been supplying LPG cylinders to local residents without issuing receipts, allegedly to maximise profits. Officials said the activity not only violated provisions of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, but also posed a significant risk to public safety.

A case has been registered under relevant sections of the Act and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, and the accused has been

taken into custody.

During interrogation, Shahnawaz disclosed that he sourced the cylinders with the help of an associate, Mukesh, who is currently absconding. The cylinders were allegedly procured from near an Indane gas agency in Laliyani village in Meerut and transported to Delhi via a pickup vehicle before being loaded into the seized Tata Ace. Police said the accused had brought around 70 cylinders from Uttar Pradesh a day before his arrest and sold them at inflated prices. Efforts are underway to trace the co-accused and probe the wider supply chain. **MP/ST**

Capital plans Tourism Board to boost tourism, film shoots

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is preparing to establish a dedicated Tourism Board aimed at positioning the capital as a major centre for tourism and film production, officials said on Monday. The proposal is expected to be introduced as a Bill during the upcoming Budget session of the Delhi Assembly, which begins on March 23.

According to officials, the proposed board will serve as a unified platform bringing together multiple government departments and agencies. Its primary objective will be to streamline efforts and enhance coordination for promoting Delhi as both a tourist destination and a preferred location



for film shoots.

The move is part of a broader strategy by the government to strengthen the city's appeal to filmmakers and visitors alike. In recent months, several steps have been initiated to simplify procedures for film production, including reducing associated fees and working towards a single-window clearance mechanism. This system is expected to significantly cut down the time and complexity involved in obtaining approvals from

different authorities.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta had earlier announced that a comprehensive film policy is under development to attract more production houses to the national capital. A key component of this policy is the introduction of a time-bound, single-window system to facilitate permissions required for shooting.

To support these efforts, the government has also allocated a dedicated fund of Rs.3 crore for initiatives aimed at developing Delhi into a film-friendly destination. Officials say measures will boost domestic filmmaking and attract global productions. Delhi will host its first international film festival from March 25, showcasing its potential as a filming hub.

Delhi govt plans Rs 800 crore Dwarka medical college with modern facilities

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is planning to set up a medical college in Dwarka area with an estimated cost of more than Rs 800 crore, officials said on Tuesday.

The proposal of a medical college to be built in Sector 17 of Dwarka in southwest Delhi was recently discussed in a meeting headed by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, they said.

The new medical college will have an eight-storeyed academic block, hostels for students, faculty residences, sports ground, among others. The academic block will have four lecture theatres of 180-person capacity each, according to an official document.

Practical labs, teaching



‘Two hostels for MBBS students will accommodate 338 boys and girls each. There will also be hostel facilities for post graduate students, interns’

classrooms of seating capacity for 25 students each, and a central library of seating capacity of 300 persons will be part of the medical college's academic block.

Smart classrooms with interactive display, acoustics in lecture theatres, audio-video system, access control, CCTV cameras, and charging infra for electric vehicles will be features of the building.

It will be a green building with energy efficiency features

like high efficiency LED lighting, high performance thermal insulation, weather resistant, high solar reflectance coating, rainwater harvesting, sewage treatment plant, and rooftop solar panels, among others.

The two hostels for MBBS students will accommodate 338 boys and girls each. There will also be hostel facilities for post graduate students and interns.

The faculty residences will involve Type 4, Type 5 and Type 6 quarters.

The proposal of a medical college with an estimated cost of Rs 806 crore was submitted for approval of the government, the officials said.

The government is also considering redevelopment of Maulana Azad Medical College and Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Medical College campuses, they said.

A proposal for the redevelopment work with a preliminary estimate of Rs 13.44 crore for consultancy services has also been submitted to the government by the health department.

The redevelopment work will include structural audit of buildings constructed before 2000 as well as planning, design and construction of new buildings, they added.

Man shoots self on camera, dies

NEW DELHI: A 28-year-old man died after allegedly shooting himself with a licensed pistol in east Delhi's New Ashok Nagar area, police said on Monday.

The incident came to light after Dharamshila Hospital in Vasundhara Enclave informed police about a medico-legal case involving a gunshot injury on March 16. The victim, identified as Pawan Kumar, a resident of Dallupura village, was brought to the hospital unconscious with a gunshot wound to the left side of his chest and was declared brought dead.

Police teams rushed to the hospital and initiated an inquiry. Preliminary investigation indicated that the incident took place at the victim's residence in Dallupura. Crime and forensic teams examined both the scene and the hospital, collecting evidence. Investigators said initial findings suggest the injury was self-inflicted. The weapon used was a licensed pistol belonging to the victim's cousin, Himanshu. Police have seized the firearm along with 10 live cartridges and taken the cousin's mobile phone into custody. Video shows victim allegedly shooting himself while being recorded. Police are analysing footage and forensic evidence to establish sequence of events, rule out foul play; body sent for post-mortem, investigation underway. **MP/ST**

Woman assaulted, gold bangle snatched in daylight robbery

NEW DELHI: A woman was allegedly assaulted and robbed of her gold bangle by four motorcycle-borne men in east Delhi's Krishna Nagar on Tuesday morning, police said, adding that CCTV footage of the incident has surfaced online.

The incident occurred around 7.15 am when the victim, Kanika Mehta, had dropped her daughter at a school bus stop and was about to leave on her scooter. Four men on two stolen motorcycles, wearing helmets, surrounded her.

Police said one accused struck her with a blunt object while another brandished a firearm before snatching her bangle. The woman sustained minor injuries. The accused allegedly fired in the air while fleeing. A case has been registered, and teams are analysing CCTV footage to identify and trace them. **MP/ST**

JETTING MACHINES TO AID THOROUGH CLEANING

Cleanliness drive in NDMC areas targets mkts, offices, metro hubs

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has intensified its sanitation efforts across key public spaces, launching a special cleanliness drive in parking areas under its jurisdiction as part of a broader push to improve urban hygiene and environmental conditions.

The initiative, undertaken under the leadership of Keshav Chandra, Chairperson of NDMC, focuses on high-footfall zones including markets, schools, colleges, government offices, religious places and metro stations. Officials said the drive aims to ensure cleaner, well-maintained public spaces while addressing dust pollution and sanitation concerns in busy urban pockets.

Sanitation workers, including both men and women, were actively engaged in sweeping,



waste collection and maintenance activities across multiple locations.

The participation of a diverse workforce highlighted the scale and inclusivity of the campaign.

Residents have also lauded the initiative. One noted, "NDMC's efforts contribute greatly to a healthier urban environment," while another described the sanitation drive as "truly commendable" and inspiring for civic bodies working towards a cleaner city.

As part of upcoming festive preparations, NDMC has announced an intensified cleanliness campaign around religious sites ahead of the Navratri festival beginning March 19.

A deep cleaning exercise will be carried out on March 17 and 18, particularly around temples across all circles. Officials said jetting machines will be deployed by the concerned engineering departments wherever required to ensure thorough cleaning.

“Such initiatives reflect NDMC’s continued commitment to building a cleaner, greener, healthier New Delhi”

The civic body said the campaign is part of a sustained effort to promote environmental sustainability and strengthen sanitation infrastructure. It also urged citizens to actively participate by maintaining cleanliness in public spaces.

Officials added that such initiatives reflect NDMC's continued commitment to building a cleaner, greener and healthier New Delhi through coordinated civic action and community involvement.

MCD inspects key areas

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Tuesday carried out a surprise field inspection in parts of Central Zone, including Nizamuddin and nearby areas, as part of its ongoing cleanliness drive. The inspection was conducted under the supervision of Deputy Commissioner (Central Zone) Shashwat Saurabh, with senior officials reviewing sanitation conditions at dhalaoes, public spaces and major roads. Authorities assessed cleanliness along Lala Lajpat Rai Marg in Nizamuddin and extended inspections to Nehru Place.

During the drive, encroach-

ments were removed from several public areas, particularly in Nizamuddin Basti. Officials also took action against illegal occupation of footpaths in Aastha Kunj Park and Okhla Phase-III, aiming to restore accessibility and improve civic conditions. Officials said the drive focused on staff accountability alongside cleanliness, with strict instructions on attendance and performance. Regular monitoring, consistent sanitation standards and anti-encroachment measures were stressed. MCD said such inspections aim to strengthen implementation and improve public spaces. **MP/ST**



Police Commissioner Satish Golchha unveils 'Delhi Police Newsletter' at the Police HQ **PIC/MP/ST**

MISSION SHAKTI INITIATIVES SHOWCASED AT SANKALP HUB

Delhi Budget to have key initiatives for women, girls: CM Rekha Gupta

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said there will be major announcements for women and girls in Budget 2026-27 to be tabled in the Delhi Assembly later this month.

Attending the 'Nari Utsav' programme at Nirmal Chhaya Complex, she lauded women for their nation-building role, said a statement from the Delhi Chief Minister's Office (CMO).

She announced that the upcoming Delhi Budget to be presented on March 24 will include key initiatives for women and girls.

The chief minister reiterated her government's commitment to the holistic empowerment of women and children, citing various schemes includ-



HIGHLIGHTS

» She announced that the upcoming Delhi Budget to be presented on March 24 will include key initiatives for women and girls

» Chief minister reiterated her gov't's commitment to the holistic empowerment of women and children, citing various schemes including 'Lakhpati Bitiya' and 'Pink Saheli' smart cards for free bus travel

» Highlighting the importance of self-help groups, she said women will be provided employment and entrepreneurship opportunities via small group-based models, and stressed the need to expand platforms like 'Mahila Haat' to help women showcase their products

» Chief Minister Gupta also inspected Nirmal Chhaya complex including the care home for women, Balika Grih and Bal Niketan

ing 'Lakhpati Bitiya' and 'Pink Saheli' smart cards for free bus travel to women.

Highlighting the importance of self-help groups (SHGs), she said women in Delhi will be provided employment and entrepreneurship opportunities through small

group-based models, and stressed the need to expand platforms like 'Mahila Haat' to help women showcase and sell their products.

"The Delhi government's focus is not just on launching schemes but on ensuring their effective implementation so

that benefits reach every needy individual," Gupta said.

The chief minister also inspected Nirmal Chhaya complex including the care home for women, Balika Grih and Bal Niketan, and enquired about facilities being provided to the occupants of these homes.

She visited Sankalp Hub, where activities related to women's safety, awareness and empowerment under Mission Shakti were showcased. At the SHG-run 'Mahila Haat', she reviewed local products and exhibitions, including nutritious millet-based dishes.

MCD dedicates link rd to Sukhram Pahalwan

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Mayor Raja Iqbal Singh on inaugurated and named a key road in North-West Delhi as 'Late Chaudhary Shri Sukhram Pahalwan Marg', honouring the late social worker for his contribution to community service and regional development.

The road connects Bakhtawarpur village to Tajpur village in Ward No. 5 and is expected to serve as an important local link for residents. The naming ceremony was held in Bakhtawarpur in the presence of several public representatives and local officials. Among those present were North-West Delhi Member of Parliament Yogendra Chandoliya, Narela MLA Raj Karan Khatri, MCD Rural Committee Chairman Yogesh Rana, and councillors Dinesh Bhardwaj, Shweta Khatri and Rituu. Nominated councillor Laxman Arya and Bakhtawarpur ward councillor and Narela Zone Vice-Chairperson Janta Devi also attended the event.

Addressing the gathering, Singh said that the late Chaudhary Sukhram Pahalwan had made significant contributions to social service and the development of the region. He noted



“Road connects Bakhtawarpur village to Tajpur village in Ward No. 5 and is expected to serve as an important local link for residents”

that naming the road after him was a tribute from the local community and a recognition of his enduring legacy.

"The naming of this road reflects the respect and gratitude of the people for his dedicated service," the Mayor said.

Civic officials said such initiatives aim to honour individuals who have played a vital role in community development while also strengthening local identity. Residents welcomed the move, describing it as a meaningful recognition of Sukhram Pahalwan's contributions to the area.

PWD to launch in-house quality tests for materials used in road construction: Min

NEW DELHI: To ensure quality roads, the Public Works Department (PWD) is planning to set up its own material testing mechanism, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Tuesday.

As per current rules, the department mandates that all contractors involved in its road infrastructure projects conduct sample tests from a reputable engineering college.

"Currently, we have a process where several engineering colleges and expert institutes carry out testing of material samples at work sites. The same is the method for quality audits after completion of projects. We plan to start our own sam-



ple and road quality testing mechanism, and we are procuring required equipment for this," PWD minister said.

In the initial stage, road quality testing will be initiated. This will save valuable time as many of these reports take two to three months to prepare, while also ensuring better quality of work. For roads, the PWD will procure a block cutter machine to test bitumen quality, Singh added.

The existing rules state, necessary tests are required to be conducted in the laboratory of Central Road Research Institute, IIT-Delhi, Jamia Milia Islamia, National Institute of Technology Delhi, and any other government engineering college approved by the engineer in charge of the project.

According to government officials, on several PWD roads where repair work is ongoing, quality testing will commence soon, and further changes will be made based on the reports.

'Delhi government plans to repair 600 km of capital roads'

Planned road repairs will be carried out in the laboratory of Central Road Research Institute, IIT-Delhi, Jamia Milia Islamia, National Institute of Technology Delhi, and any other government engineering college approved by the engineer in charge of the project.

According to government officials, on several PWD roads where repair work is ongoing, quality testing will commence soon, and further changes will be made based on the reports.

Future of nation-building is digital but heart must remain human: L-G

OUR CORRESPONDENT

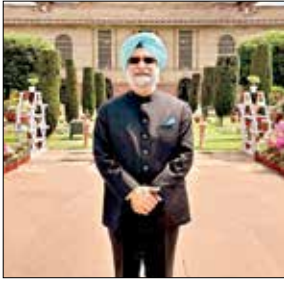
NEW DELHI: L-G Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday said the future of nation-building is digital but its heart must remain human.

Sandhu, the former diplomat and newly appointed L-G, was delivering the keynote address at Global Confluence 2026 organised by the National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM).

Sandhu recalled his long association with NASSCOM since his role as a diplomat in the USA, and added that it was apt that the Global Confluence organised by the Association was one of his first events in his capacity as Delhi L-G.

He was administered the oath as Delhi's 23rd L-G on March 11.

"History teaches us that nations are built on foundations of stone, steel and sweat. But in 2026, the architecture of nation-building has changed.



"Today, the most vital infrastructure is often invisible. It exists in the pulses of fibre-optic cables, the logic of algorithms and the seamless flow of data," Sandhu said.

In large and diverse democracies such as India, technology becomes particularly important as it enables systems to operate at scale. No one has demonstrated the transformative power of technology better than India, he asserted.

"Under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister (Narendra Modi), we have harnessed this power through initiatives such as Digital Pub-

lic Infrastructure (DPIs), Atal Tinkering Labs, Start Up India, Digital India, IndiaAI Mission, Semicon Mission and the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)," he cited various initiatives of the central government. The ultimate aim of any innovation has to be the improvement in the lives of the people, he said, and added, "We see the use of drones for getting our vaccines across to remote areas, the creation of tractor-sharing apps among our farmers and the use of AI to ensure the optimal use of fertilisers and pesticides." Highlighting India's digital transformation, the L-G said that in the past decade, the country has witnessed one of the most remarkable digital transformations.

India's vast, affordable internet drives innovation and transactions. Sandhu highlighted DPI, UPI's global reach, and stressed inclusive, human-centric digital growth, urging focus on research, skills, collaboration and ambition.

Forest dept plans 70L+ plantations across city

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi forest department is planning a plantation target of 70.82 lakh for 2026-27 under its Green Action Plan (GAP), with officials saying activities are underway in this regard with pruning of canopies of older foliage to create conditions for sapling growth.

"There appears to be agreement on adopting the canopy opening method, following which plantation work can proceed," an official said, indicating that the approach is still under consideration.

The official said discussion in this regard took place during a meeting held in February. Explaining the plantation method, the official said canopy opening involves selectively pruning dense tree cover to create gaps that allow sunlight to reach the ground, thereby improving conditions for planting new saplings and enhancing their survival rate by reducing competition for light, water and nutrients.

The approach is expected to be complemented by a three-layered plantation model, the official said, adding that it comprises tall native trees in the

Discussion in this regard took place during a meeting held in February

top canopy, smaller trees and shrubs in the middle canopy to trap dust and pollutants, and grasses and low-lying vegetation in the ground layer to prevent soil erosion and retain moisture.

"Together, the multi-tiered system is aimed at improving air quality, enhancing carbon absorption and supporting urban biodiversity. It also helps reduce pollutants such as particulate matter (PM10 and PM2.5), nitrogen oxides, sulphur dioxide, ozone and carbon dioxide by trapping and absorbing them at different vegetation levels," the official added. Officials reviewed 2026-27 plantation targets, layered planting strategy and training plans. Under the 2025-26 plan, over 67.98 lakh of the 75 lakh target has been achieved. Authorities directed completion by March, data uploads on the GAP portal, and ordered third-party audits using satellite and ground verification.

L-G urged to install audible traffic signals for visually impaired: Gupta

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a push for more inclusive urban infrastructure, Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta has written to Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, urging the installation of audible traffic signals across the city to assist Divyangjan and senior citizens.

In his letter, Gupta highlighted the daily challenges faced by visually impaired pedestrians and the elderly while navigating busy roads. Emphasising the need for accessible infrastructure,

he stated that the absence of sound-based crossing systems puts a large section of citizens at risk.

Referring to data from the Dr. Rajendra Prasad Centre for Ophthalmic Sciences at AIIMS, the Speaker noted that nearly 60 lakh people in Delhi suffer from vision-related issues. Of these, around 12 to 18 lakh individuals live with significant low vision, many of whom are senior citizens.

He pointed out that the current traffic system, which relies heavily on visual cues, is inadequate for their needs.

Gupta wrote, "The lack of accessible crossing aids poses a constant risk of accidents and limits the mobility of a vast section of the population." He further stressed that installing audible signals is essential to ensure safer mobility for vulnerable groups.

Citing Japan, the UK and the US, he said sound-based traffic systems use audio cues to aid pedestrians. Calling audible signals essential for dignity and safety, Gupta urged the Lieutenant Governor to prioritise and expedite the proposal for safer, more inclusive roads.

Sood urges youth to lead nation-building

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday urged young people to play an active role in nation-building, calling them the driving force behind India's future. He was addressing the "Viksit Bharat - Yuva Connect" programme at Don Bosco Institute of Technology.

Sood said nation-building depends not only on government efforts but also on the responsibility and resolve of youth. Referring to the vision of a developed India by 2047, he described young citizens as



the "architects" of the country's future.

He said the programme aims to connect youth with the national vision and encourage participation. Highlighting initiatives under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, he also noted the 'MY Bharat' initiative promoting volunteerism.

Nitin Nabin arrives in Delhi, welcomed by CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday welcomed Nitin Nabin at the Delhi Airport during his first visit to the national capital after being elected to the Rajya Sabha from Bihar. Senior BJP leaders and workers were present at the reception.

Gupta congratulated Nabin



and expressed confidence in his leadership, saying his

presence in Parliament would strengthen public welfare and national interest. She said his experience and political acumen would contribute meaningfully to legislative work.

Nabin's visit is expected to include organisational meetings with party leaders to strengthen coordination between the central leadership and state units.

CM Rekha Gupta attends 'Nari Utsav' & inspects key facilities

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday attended the 'Nari Utsav' programme at the Nirmal Chhaya Complex, where she highlighted the role of women in nation-building and inspected key facilities for women and children.

Addressing the event, Gupta said women are playing a leading role in shaping the country's future through their dedication and service. "Women, through their dedication, selfless service and sense of duty, are driving the country towards the goal of Viksit Bharat 2047," she said.

During her visit, the Chief Minister reviewed facilities including the After Care Home, Balika Grih and Bal Niketan, interacting with residents and assessing arrangements related to safety, nutrition and overall care. She emphasised that empowerment must be built on "safety, dignity and self-reliance," adding that "every woman deserves a secure environment, respect in all circumstances, and



opportunities to become financially independent."

Gupta also indicated that the upcoming Delhi Budget will prioritise women-centric initiatives. "Major announcements for women and girls are likely in the upcoming Budget," she said, highlighting plans to expand employment and entrepreneurship opportunities through Self-Help Groups (SHGs).

She stressed the importance of effective implementation of welfare schemes. "Our focus is not just on launching schemes, but on ensuring their benefits

reach every needy individual," she said. The Chief Minister also reviewed initiatives under the Department of Women and Child Development, including the 'Samarth Anganwadi' and 'Mahila Haat', and appreciated SHG-led entrepreneurship models. She urged stronger public-private collaboration under the 'Give to Gain' initiative to upgrade anganwadi centres and expand services, reaffirming that empowering women strengthens society and the nation, and that Delhi is steadily progressing in that direction.

TEMPLE AREA TO GET FOOTPATH, RAILINGS, UPGRADES

NDMC launches 24x7 water supply pilot proj, temple beautification works in Chanakyapuri

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Tuesday launched a pilot project to provide round-the-clock water supply in parts of Chanakyapuri, while also initiating beautification works at a temple in Nehru Park as part of its infrastructure upgrade initiatives.

NDMC Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal laid the foundation stone for Phase I of the 24x7 continuous water supply project in the Vinay Marg area. The project aims to modernise the existing water distribution system and ensure uninterrupted access to clean drinking water for residents.

Chahal said the initiative



“Project will be implemented through the Vinay Marg Water Boosting Stn and will include modern VFD-based motor pump sets to ensure efficient water distribution”

Data Acquisition) system to enable better monitoring and management of the water supply network.

The ₹1.38-crore project is expected to be completed within five months and will benefit around 550 water connections in the Vinay Marg area. Officials said additional

electrical and mechanical upgrades will also be carried out in the existing pipeline network to improve reliability and efficiency.

In a parallel initiative, NDMC will undertake beautification and development works at Bhairi Mandir in Nehru Park, Chanakyapuri. The project, estimated at around ₹11 lakh, includes improvements to the entry gate, installation of railings, development of an RMC footpath, enhancement of tree guards and red-stone cladding of the temple well.

Civic officials said the works aim to improve public amenities and enhance the aesthetic appeal of the area for visitors and devotees.

Mamata

The party has also sought to maintain social balance in its nominations, fielding 78 Scheduled Caste (SC)

Without naming Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, she remarked: "Why are you acting from behind the clouds?" and dared him to join the BJP campaign. She alleged that newly appointed officers were chosen to help the BJP move cash and arms ahead of the polls and "trigger riots". "Why was there so much hurry?" she asked,

Iran strikes

Rising tensions have driven oil prices sharply higher. Brent crude remained above 100 dollars per barrel, marking an increase of more than 40 per cent since the conflict began. The surge has added pressure on Washington, where President Donald Trump said he had urged several countries to deploy naval forces to ensure freedom

Larijani, a prominent political figure from a well-known family, had served as parliamentary speaker and as a senior adviser on nuclear negotiations. He also previously headed Iran's Supreme National Security Council. Soleimani led the Basij militia, a para-military force accused by Israel and Western governments of suppressing domestic protests through arrests and force. He had been sanctioned by the United States, the European Union and others for his role in internal crackdowns. The reported killings add to mounting losses within Iran's leadership. Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was killed in an airstrike on the first day of the conflict, and several other senior officials have also died since then. Israel said it carried out a "wide-scale wave of strikes" across Tehran, targeting command centres, missile launch sites and air defence systems. It also intensified attacks on Hezbollah positions in Lebanon. The Israeli military reported incoming Iranian missile barrages before dawn targeting Tel Aviv and other areas, alongside rocket fire from Lebanon toward Israel's north. In response to incoming threats, the UAE temporarily shut its airspace early Tuesday as its military engaged missile

Gurjeet Singh Aujla said the episode reflected the strength of democratic expression. "India's democracy stands strongest when voices are heard, not silenced," he said, adding that the MPs would continue to stand united for democratic values.

Before rejoining proceedings, the seven Congress MPs paid tribute at the statue of Mahatma Gandhi within the Parliament premises.

Congress MP Prashant Padole described the revocation as a positive outcome. "Truth has prevailed. Going forward, we will raise the issues of the people in Parliament and continue to fight for their rights," he said.

SC scraps

childbirth and is rooted in the broader concept of mother-

The court also urged the Centre to introduce provisions recognising paternity leave as part of social security benefits. It underlined that maternity leave is a basic human right that supports equality in the workplace while safeguarding maternal and child health. Extending such benefits, the bench noted, is essential for enabling women to balance caregiving responsibilities with economic independence.

PM Modi

LPG supply

This compares to 50 lakh deliveries in pre-conflict times," she said. There is still panic booking happening despite assurances that there are enough LPG supplies to meet household needs, she said. To ease pressure on LPG,

The disruption has begun to ripple through several sectors that rely heavily on LPG. Restaurants have started dropping slow-simmered dishes from their menus because they consume large amounts of cooking gas, while industries, such as brick and tile manufacturing, ceramics and glass kilns, are also facing difficulties in sustaining operations due to gas shortage.

As many as 12,000 raids have been conducted and 15,000 cylinders seized, the official said, adding that oil companies have conducted 2,500 surprise inspections of LPG dealerships and petrol pumps. Meanwhile, a second Indian-flagged LPG tanker reached the country early Tuesday after safely sailing from the war-hit Strait of Hormuz, and efforts are on to ensure the safe passage of the remaining 22 Indian vessels still stranded in the conflict zone.

The Nagpur bench of the court accepted the Centre's submission and disposed of the petition filed by LPG distributors, noting that it is taking "all the necessary steps in the matter to protect the interests of individuals".

- Transformation of cultural-spiritual tourist spots
- 156 Crore+ tourists visited in 2025
- World-class temple museum underway in Ayodhya
- Rashtra Prerna Sthal in Lucknow
- 96 Lakh+ MSMEs operational
- One District-One Cuisine Scheme launched

Charges of 'horse trading' fly after cross-voting in Rajya Sabha polls

‘Over Rs 81,500 crore released to states, UTs under MGNREGA’

Modi meets Varun Gandhi

The BRICS, originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa, expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran and the UAE, with Indonesia joining in 2025.

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Ministry of Tribal Affairs
Government of India

BTF 18 - 30 March
2026

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Bharat Tribes Business & CSR
Conclave for national and global
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Inauguration

by

Shri Jual Oram

Hon'ble Union Minister of Tribal Affairs

In the august presence of

Shri Durgadas Uikey

Hon'ble Union Minister of State for Tribal Affairs

18 March 2026

05:00 pm

Sunder Nursery, New Delhi

“Our Government has been steadfast in its efforts towards empowerment of our tribal communities and preservation of their traditions. We are working tirelessly to transform the tribal-rural economic system.”

Narendra Modi, Prime Minister

Nearest Metro Station - JLN Stadium #BharatTribesFest #Vocal4Local #BuyTribal

‘BOTH SIDES SHOULD BE FLEXIBLE’

Sonam Wangchuk hopes for ‘meaningful dialogue’ with Centre

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: In his first public remarks after being released from jail, activist Sonam Wangchuk on Tuesday said he wanted to see the development in a “positive light” and hoped it would lead to a “meaningful dialogue” on the demands of agitating bodies in Ladakh.

Addressing a press conference here along with his wife and HIAL co-founder Gitanjali J Angmo, Wangchuk said the protests in Ladakh have been aimed solely at initiating a constructive dialogue process.

He also said that talks are a “give and take process” and both sides will have to make “certain accommodations.”

“We were sure of a victory in the court, but a win was not enough. I wanted a win-win,” he said.

He also expressed the hope that the Supreme Court would rule on the Habeas Corpus petition filed by his wife to set a precedent.

Wangchuk described the government’s move to release him as an “extending of hand to build trust and to facilitate meaningful, constructive dialogue.”

“They have offered a constructive, meaningful dialogue. This is what we have wanted, and we had to struggle so much, walk to Delhi, sit on ‘anshan’ (fast). All movements in Ladakh are for starting the dialogue process,” he said.

“Usually, you see people picking up guns and the government appealing for dialogue. Here, people are urging the government to start a dialogue,” he said.

He hoped it would not just be a dialogue, but “meaningful, effective talks, which lead us to



Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk with spouse Gitanjali J Angmo during a press conference, in New Delhi, Tuesday

HIGHLIGHTS

» Wangchuk said the protests in Ladakh have been aimed solely at initiating a constructive dialogue process

» He also expressed the hope that the SC would rule on the Habeas Corpus petition filed by his wife to set a precedent

something good.”

Talking about the incidents in Ladakh, he said many “meaningless arrests” occurred. “Even people who were going to donate blood got arrested and got an FIR. Such things have happened,” he claimed.

He said it should be examined how the violence started.

“There are also voices among people that ask -- where did it start? How did this violence start? Actually, that must be examined.

“There are voices that ask how come so many people died with injuries in the chest? But I think all this could be undone. People can take back their sus-

picious and doubts and the government can take back their cases,” he said.

Asked about his next step, Wangchuk said he would travel to Ladakh and consult with leaders of the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), which have been spearheading the agitation over the past five years for statehood and extension of the Sixth Schedule to Ladakh.

On whether he would return to agitation, he said: “I have always said I don’t want to sit on hunger strike; I am forced to do it. Now that the government is extending its hand, we hope a good example is set.”

He also said that when dialogues are held with the Centre, both sides should be flexible and accommodating.

“Overall, the two main issues are safeguards under the Sixth Schedule, statehood, or the restoration of democracy... So as I said, it involves give and take. Therefore, if not on both, we would hope on one... That’s how we want to expect to give and take and be flexible in the interest of nation building,” he said.

Ruckus in Haryana Assembly over RS poll

Chief Minister Saini accuses Congress of indulging in ‘headline politics’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday launched a sharp attack on the Congress in the Assembly, accusing it of indulging in “headline politics” and levelling baseless allegations instead of engaging in constructive debate.

The Haryana Assembly witnessed chaotic scenes as Congress members attempted to raise the issue of the Rajya Sabha elections in Haryana, alleging a “murder of democracy”. The ruckus led to repeated disruptions, a brief adjournment, the naming of eight Congress MLAs by the Speaker, and eventually a walkout by the Opposition.

Replying to the discussion on the state Budget during the ongoing session, Saini said the Opposition was unable to appreciate the pace of development in Haryana and was viewing the Budget through a “distorted lens”. He strongly objected to remarks by senior Congress leader Raghuvir Kadian, who had termed the Rajya Sabha election process questionable

Internal feud hits Haryana Congress

SWATI MAHAJAN

CHANDIGARH: The Congress’ brief celebrations over the victory of its Rajya Sabha candidate Karamveer Baudh were overshadowed by an internal turmoil, as senior leader Ram Kishan Gujjar resigned from the post of Working President of the Haryana Pradesh Congress Committee as well as from the party’s primary membership.

The development came amid allegations of cross-voting during the March 16 Rajya Sabha polls. In a swift damage-control move, the party issued show-cause notices to five MLAs—Shaili Chaudhary, Pradeep Chaudhary, Shamsheer Singh Gogi, Mewa Singh and Renu Bala—who were named in a “traitor list” and are believed to be loyalists of Kumari Selja.

and alleged vote theft.

Calling such claims “misleading and irresponsible”, Saini asserted that the Congress was resorting to unfounded criticism. “Aarop lagao aur bhaag jao has become their habit,” he said, taking a swipe at the Opposition for staging a walkout instead of

participating in discussions.

In the elections held on Monday, Sanjay Bhatia of the BJP and Karamveer Baudh were elected to the Rajya Sabha, while Independent candidate Satish Nandal lost narrowly.

Rejecting allegations of a looming debt crisis, Saini said

Haryana’s financial position was stronger than that of neighbouring Punjab and accused the Congress of spreading a false narrative. He also highlighted a Rs 100 crore provision for the Sutlej Yamuna Link canal in the Budget, dismissing claims of neglect.

Hooda alleges ‘vote theft’ in Hry RS poll

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Tuesday accused the BJP of “vote theft” in the Rajya Sabha elections in the state, alleging misuse of power and manipulation of the electoral process.

Addressing a press conference, Hooda claimed the BJP vindicated allegations made by Rahul Gandhi by fielding a second candidate despite lacking numbers. He also alleged that four valid votes of Congress MLAs were arbitrarily invalidated by the Returning Officer.

Hooda warned that party legislators involved in cross-voting would face strict action. He also dismissed social media claims, asserting that Badli MLA Kuldeep Vats voted in favour of the Congress candidate.

FIR LODGED, 14 HELD

Varanasi: ‘Iftar’ on boat in Ganga sparks protest

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

VARANASI: Police have registered a case and detained 14 youths following allegations that non-vegetarian food was consumed during an iftar gathering on a boat in the Ganga and left-overs were thrown into the river, triggering protests.

The complaint was filed at Kotwali Police Station by Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha city president Rajat Jaiswal. In the complaint, Jaiswal alleged that a group of youths from the Muslim community held an iftar on a boat in the Ganga, consumed chicken biryani and disposed of the remaining food in the river. He claimed that the act hurt

religious sentiments and caused anger among the public. He further alleged that the incident was carried out deliberately with the intention of hurting Hindu sentiments.

A video of the alleged incident was also submitted to the police.

Jaiswal has demanded action against those involved as well as against the boat operator, including cancellation of the boat’s licence to prevent recurrence of such incidents. Station House Officer Dayashankar Singh said an FIR has been registered on the basis of the complaint. He confirmed that 14 youths have been taken into custody and are being questioned. Further investigation in the matter is underway.

Punjab launches Sikhya Kranti 2.0

CHANDIGARH: The AAP government on Tuesday said it has launched ‘Punjab Sikhya Kranti 2.0’, a transformative new phase of school education reform involving an outlay of Rs 3,500 crore over the next six years.

The initiative aims to deepen structural reforms in government schools and align Punjab’s education ecosystem with global standards, said an official statement.

The state government has also entered into a collaboration with the World Bank to support the implementation of the programme.

The partnership reflects international recognition of the measurable progress Punjab has already achieved in public education reforms, it said.

The Rs 3,500-crore mission comprises Rs 2,500 crore of the World Bank loan assistance and Rs 1,000 crore from the state gov-

Rs 3,500-cr mission comprises Rs 2,500 cr of the World

Bank loan assistance and Rs 1,000 cr from the state govt

ernment, it said.

Over the past two years, the state has operationalised structured career guidance systems, expanded access to science and commerce streams, strengthened teacher training ecosystems and modernised school infrastructure across thousands of institutions, ensuring that reforms move beyond announcements to measurable outcomes.

These systemic reforms have laid a strong and credible foundation, it said, adding Punjab

Sikhya Kranti 2.0 now seeks to institutionalise these gains and prepare the state’s education system to compete with the best in the world.

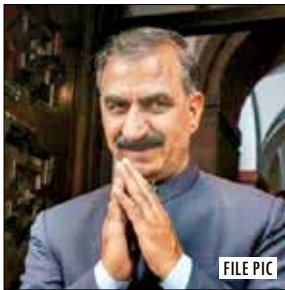
Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said the success of Punjab Sikhiya Kranti has already rewritten the education narrative of the state.

“Punjab has shown that government schools can lead the nation. Ranking number one in PARAKH Rashtriya Sarvekshan 2024 is proof of that transformation. With Punjab Sikhiya Kranti 2.0, we are now preparing our education system to compete with the best in the world. “The collaboration with the World Bank reflects the credibility and transparency with which Punjab has carried out education reforms. ‘This is the next leap forward in our commitment to every child,’ said the chief minister. MPOST

EFFORTS TO CUT COSTS AMID DEBT BURDEN

HP strips chairmen, vice-chairmen of Cabinet rank

ASHWANI SHARMA



SHIMLA: Hit hard by the fiscal crisis and escalating debt burden, the Himachal Pradesh government has stripped all chairmen and vice-chairmen of the boards and corporations, as well as principal advisors to the chief minister, of Cabinet rank and implemented a 20 percent deferral for the next six months.

The move, which comes ahead of Chief Minister Sukh-winder Singh Sukhu presenting the state’s Budget for 2026-27 in the Assembly on March 21, indicates a grim financial situation and also sends a message about some hard decisions in the upcoming budget.

In a notification issued on Tuesday, the General Admin-

istration Department of the government asked all administrative secretaries to take necessary action to implement the orders.

The notification states: “the ‘Cabinet rank’ status given to several appointees—including chairmen, vice-chairmen, deputy chairmen of boards and corporations, and principal and political advisers—has

been taken away immediately to help simplify administrative procedures and cut costs.”

Chief Minister’s principal media advisor Naresh Chauhan, who also held the Cabinet rank, said the decision taken by the Chief Minister was in the larger interest of the state and aimed to send a strong message in the state about the government’s intentions to cut down administrative expenditures in view of the financial crunch faced after the 16th finance commission stopped the Revenue Deficit Grant for the state.

The Chief Minister said that, in the manner in which the about Rs 10,000 crore annual Revenue Deficit Grant (RDG) for Himachal has been discontinued by the centre, there is a need to push reforms.

“We want to make Himachal self-reliant,” said Sukhu.

The CM hinted that this era was just the beginning, and in the near future, more such reforms will be seen. “To begin with, we have withdrawn the cabinet rank given to these people, but in the near future, more such reforms will be taken, considering the financial health of the state,” he said.

Sukhu said the preparation for the Budget for 2026-27 is underway, and several other steps aimed at pushing in reforms are also being contemplated, he added.

The Assembly’s Budget session will resume on Wednesday with debate on the governor’s address, which will be followed by the budget presentation on Saturday.

Prez Murmu to attend Shri Ram Yantra installation in Ayodhya

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The temple town of Ayodhya is preparing for another major religious ceremony with the installation of Shri Ram Yantra at the Ram Temple scheduled for March 19. President Droupadi Murmu will attend the event as the chief guest.

The ceremony is being organised on Varsh Pratipada, the first day of Chaitra Navratri, which marks the beginning of the Hindu New Year. The Uttar Pradesh government and the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust have drawn up elaborate arrangements for the occasion.

According to Champat Rai, general secretary of the Trust, the Shri Ram Yantra was brought to Ayodhya two years ago through a ceremonial procession led by Vijayendra Saraswati. The yantra, based on Vedic mathematics and geometric patterns, is considered sacred and is believed to symbolise divine energy and positive spiritual vibrations. It is currently being worshipped before Raja Ram and will be installed on the second floor of the Ram Temple on March 19.

Preparations for the ceremony are already under way with a nine day Vedic ritual that has begun in the temple premises. Priests and scholars from South India, Varanasi and Ayodhya are participating in the rituals. Around 7,000 people are expected to attend the ceremony, including several individuals from Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand who were associated with the construction of the temple.

President Murmu is scheduled to arrive in Ayodhya at around 11 am. She will be received by Uttar Pradesh Governor Anandiben Patel and Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. After reaching the temple complex, the President will offer prayers before the Shri Ram Yantra.

Delhi HC orders removal of posts linking Puri’s daughter to Epstein

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday directed the removal of social media content linking Union minister Hardeep Singh Puri’s daughter to convicted American sex offender late Jeffrey Epstein within 24 hours.

Justice Mini Pushkarna also restrained several users from publishing, circulating or disseminating such content on social media platforms in any manner.

The judge, who was hearing a lawsuit filed by Hardeep Puri’s daughter, Himayani Puri, clarified that if social media users did not remove the posts, the concerned platforms shall take down or block access to such content.

The court also observed that Himayani Puri has a prima facie case in her favour and she will suffer irreparable injury if

interim relief is not granted.

“Consequently, till the next date of hearing, the following directions are issued,” the court said, while listing the case for further hearing in August.

Senior advocate Mahesh Jethmalani, appearing for the plaintiff, said she has a “global reputation” to protect as a finance professional and that the allegations against her were “completely false, reckless and malicious”.

Calling the allegations a “figment of imagination”, Jethmalani argued that there was an “orchestrated attack” on the plaintiff, arising from “personal and political malice”.

He said the defamatory content was published and shared by users who were “self-proclaimed journalists” or content creators.

Jethmalani also told the court that the plaintiff was a resident of New York and urged the court to pass an order to block the defamatory content globally.

Senior advocate Arvind Datar, appearing for Meta Platforms, submitted that such orders were not passed in any country and that the blocking of objectionable content was done country-wise.

He informed the court that the issue of a global blocking was pending before a division bench of the high court.

Restricting the take-down order to India at this stage, the court issued summonses on the lawsuit to the users and social media platforms, asking them to file their responses in the main case as well as the application for interim relief. AGENCIES

‘FIRST IN THE COUNTRY’

Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan sign MoUs with Centre for JJM 2.0 rollout

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant step to strengthen rural drinking water governance, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan first signed Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with the Centre in New Delhi on Tuesday under the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0, marking the formal rollout of reform-linked implementation of the scheme.

The Union Cabinet had approved the extended phase of the mission on March 10, 2026. With the signing of the MoUs, both states have formally joined the next phase aimed at deepening structural reforms in rural water supply systems.

The MoU with Madhya Pradesh was signed in the presence of Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, who joined the event via video conferencing, Union Jal Shakti Minister C. R. Paatil, and state Public Health Engineering Department (PHED) Minister Sampatiya Uikay. The agreement was exchanged between Principal Secretary, PHED, P. Narahari and Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary



With the signing of the MoUs, both states have formally joined the extended phase aimed at deepening structural reforms in rural water supply systems

(Water), Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS).

Rajasthan also signed its MoU at the event in the presence of Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma, with senior officials from the Centre and both states in attendance.

Addressing the event, Yadav reaffirmed Madhya Pradesh’s commitment to aligning with the national reform agenda under



JJM 2.0. He said the state would adhere to the provisions of the reform-linked MoU, focusing on strengthening governance systems, improving service delivery, moving towards 24x7 drinking water supply, and ensuring long-term sustainability of rural water schemes.

Paatil reiterated the Centre’s zero-tolerance policy on corruption, stressing that quality, transparency and accountability must

guide all works under the mission. He urged states to strictly adhere to standards to ensure durable and sustainable assets. Highlighting challenges such as water scarcity in Rajasthan and complex hydrogeological conditions in Madhya Pradesh, he described the MoUs as a strong commitment to water security. He added that effective implementation would ease the burden on women in rural areas while ensuring a safe and reliable drinking water supply.

The MoUs cover 11 key structural reform areas aimed at strengthening governance, institutional capacity and long-term sustainability of rural drinking water systems.

Nation Briefs

ASSAM: RAIL CAPACITY TO SURGE WITH KEY DOUBLING PROJECTS UNDERWAY

MALIGAON: In a major boost to railway infrastructure in the Northeast, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the Furkating–New Tinsukia Doubling Project on March 13. Spanning a total length of 194 kilometres and with an estimated cost of approximately Rs 3634 crores, this important initiative will significantly enhance rail capacity, improve operational efficiency and strengthen connectivity across Upper Assam and adjoining regions. Work on this project is being taken forward in a planned manner. At the same time, the Lumding–Furkating Double Line Project is also progressing steadily. The Lumding–Furkating section, spanning approximately 140 km, is a crucial rail corridor under Northeast Frontier Railway, officials said.



HPV CAMPAIGN: THREE LAKH GIRLS VACCINATED IN FORTNIGHT

NEW DELHI: Nearly three lakh 14-year-old girls have been vaccinated within a fortnight of the launch of the HPV vaccination campaign, marking an encouraging start to the critical public health initiative. Health ministry officials said on Tuesday that several states, including Madhya Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Odisha, and Mizoram, are leading from the front in the nationwide HPV vaccination campaign.



EDITORIAL
TRUST IN
BALLOTS?

In democracies, the battle over elections is rarely just about procedure; it is about power, legitimacy, and who gets to belong. The Safeguard American Voter Eligibility (SAVE) Act has entered this charged arena not as a routine legislative proposal, but as a flashpoint in an already polarised political landscape. Presented by Republicans as a necessary step to secure the sanctity of the ballot, and opposed by Democrats as a measure that risks reshaping the electorate, the bill goes far beyond administrative reform. By mandating documentary proof of citizenship for voter registration, enforcing nationwide voter identification, and expanding federal oversight of voter rolls, it raises fundamental questions about access, trust, and the meaning of democratic participation in the United States.

President Donald Trump's emphatic backing of the legislation underscores the political stakes involved. His assertion that the bill's passage would "guarantee the mid-terms" for Republicans reveals the extent to which electoral law has become intertwined with partisan strategy. Election rules are not neutral frameworks; they shape participation, influence turnout, and, ultimately, determine political outcomes. By linking the bill so explicitly to electoral advantage, Trump has strengthened the argument that the legislation is less about securing elections and more about influencing them. Even within Republican ranks, Senate Majority Leader John Thune's reluctance to push procedural boundaries such as ending the filibuster reflects a recognition that institutional norms, once altered, can have enduring consequences.

At the heart of the SAVE Act lies its most contentious provision: the requirement that new voters present documentary proof of citizenship. While the principle that only citizens should vote is undisputed and already enshrined in federal law, the mechanism proposed by the bill introduces significant barriers. Limiting acceptable documentation primarily to passports, birth certificates, or specific military records risks excluding millions of eligible voters who do not have ready access to such documents. In a country marked by socio-economic disparities, these requirements are unlikely to fall evenly. Elderly citizens lacking formal birth records, women whose names have changed after marriage, and low-income individuals unable to afford or obtain passports could find themselves effectively shut out of the electoral process.

This tension between electoral integrity and inclusivity extends to other provisions of the bill. The nationwide expansion of voter identification requirements, including for mail-in ballots, seeks to standardise a fragmented system but simultaneously raises concerns about federal overreach into state-controlled election processes. More troubling still is the proposal to mandate the sharing of state voter data with the Department of Homeland Security. While supporters argue that such measures would enhance verification through federal databases, critics warn of unprecedented centralisation and the risk of large-scale voter roll purges. In this context, the issue is not merely technical but deeply political: it is about whether citizens can trust the system—and the institutions managing it—to act impartially.

Equally significant is the immediacy with which the SAVE Act proposes to take effect. By requiring swift implementation ahead of upcoming elections, the bill places immense strain on state election machinery. Elections depend on careful planning, clear communication, and administrative stability. Sudden changes of this magnitude risk confusion among voters, errors in execution, and a potential erosion of public confidence. When coupled with efforts to attach unrelated provisions—ranging from restrictions on mail-in voting to broader cultural issues—the legislation begins to resemble not just an electoral reform bill, but a vehicle for wider ideological contestation.

Ultimately, the debate surrounding the SAVE Act reflects a deeper crisis of confidence in American democracy. Allegations of voter fraud, often lacking substantive evidence, coexist with persistent concerns about voter suppression, creating a climate in which trust is in short supply. In such an environment, any reform—however justified—must be measured not only by its intent but by its impact on public faith in the system. Election integrity is undeniably essential, but it cannot be pursued at the cost of accessibility. A democracy derives its legitimacy from both the security of its processes and the breadth of its participation. The challenge before lawmakers is not to choose between these principles, but to reconcile them—recognising that the strength of a democracy lies in its ability to protect both.

RISING
INDIA



MITALI MADHUSMITA

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IRS OFFICER WHO SERVED AS THE PRINCIPAL CHIEF COMMISSIONER OF INCOME TAX IN ANDHRA PRADESH AND TELANGANA

India's AI ambitions are rising fast, but the real challenge lies in aligning innovation with inclusion and national priorities

The most ancient civilisation is now facing a civilisational crisis: how to quickly turn into a global AI power! In the recent past, foreign heads of state, ministers, heads of tech giants, and who's who of the IT and AI industry converged on the national capital to deliberate on the potential impact of AI. Most see it as a must-do-or-doom scenario. The government is facilitating infrastructure, such as nuclear power and energy, chip manufacturing, rare earths, etc., to keep India on track. The cool-thinking minds are simultaneously asking the industry to pause and think about where and on whom to focus, while keeping concerns in mind. Meanwhile, the rest of the country struggles on with the mundane task of trying to earn a living and coping.

It is agreed on all sides that the new AI tools can be one of the biggest disruptors in our society and civilisation. In the past, we have been disruptors. The concept of 'zero' (acknowledged by Fibonacci himself) and other numerals, the 'decimal system', medicine, astronomy, and soft power, as manifested in religions (Buddhism, Jainism, Hinduism), culture, and the Sanskrit language, are widely disseminated Indian contributions. At one point in time, as William Dalrymple notes in his well-researched book *The Golden Road*, the vast Indosphere stretched all the way from the Red Sea to the Pacific. India will learn to survive and thrive in the AI onslaught despite all the hiccups. It might be worthwhile to illustrate why this is a plausible prediction with a few examples of our famed resilience:

Our genetic mould: We withstood wave after wave of foreign onslaughts and are still a thriving, self-reliant democracy. The fact that social and territorial jurisdictions were fragmented helped the invaders, but each wave saw more assimilation of the invaders into the existing fabric than total annihilation. It has always been about resilience, with a liberal sprinkling of tolerance and geniality. Persons of Indian origin are now CEOs at Alphabet, IBM, Microsoft, Micron, Adobe, etc.

Co-existence of science and cost: We are extremely cost-conscious and prudent in our approach. We put a rover on the moon at a fraction (USD 75 million) of the cost that the USA did (USD 38 million, present cost roughly USD 295 million) decades earlier. We are slowly indigenising our navy and artillery, building cost-friendly ships, railway coaches, generic medicines, and AI stacks for public ser-



India's success will depend on whether it can align global ambition with grassroots realities and inclusive development priorities

vices. Pragmatic grounding in science and economy in equal measure is ingrained in our psyche.

A young nation: India at present has about 12 per cent (approximately 150 million) senior citizens, i.e., 60-plus. Predominantly, vis-à-vis other countries like Japan (48.6 per cent) or the US (38.5 per cent), we are a young nation. Although this figure has been estimated by UNFPA to rise to approximately 319 million by 2025 (20 per cent of the total population), we have a 25-year period for the young demographic mass to catch up with the latest technology. The spirit of entrepreneurship, the level of awareness and adoption of the latest technology, and the ability to learn and unlearn among Gen Z are unmatched. This generation will question, rationalise, and take informed decisions. At the same time, they are not afraid to take risks; despite some failures, the number of start-ups in India is mind-boggling. The top 79 entrepreneurs under the age of 30 have raised an impressive Rs 46,800 crore in equity funding. From robots to clean septic tanks, drones to support farming, and space mapping solutions that track satellite debris to prevent collisions, these are revolutionary small fixes to make not just India but the world a better place.

Digital literacy: The government has launched several digital literacy schemes since 2014—the NDLM (National Digital Literacy Mission), DISHA (Digital Saksharta Abhiyan), and PMGDISHA (PM Gramin DISHA)—to overcome the digital literacy divide, as only 38 per cent of households are digitally literate. Private

players like Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages, PNB Ltd, and NIIT Foundation are chipping in with requisite training. The main challenge is the availability of digital infrastructure and intermittent internet connectivity in rural areas. There has been exponential growth in digital payments and unique ID adoption. Stuart Russell, a British academic and AI safety research expert, coined the term 'techno-optimism' for India, citing the success of Aadhaar as an example of adoption at scale, whereas in the US and Europe, the idea of a national ID has faced pushback.

Adoption of the new AI tools and education is thus a necessity for industry, agriculture, services, and other components of the economy in India. This approach needs to be tailored to our sovereign requirements, rather than a one-size-fits-all approach, even as big tech firms will necessarily try to depict it so. Having invested billions of dollars in the development of AI tools, they have no choice but to sell their products as labour-saving technology. In a country like India, where labour is plentiful, skilled, and affordable, the deployment of AI needs careful calibration. Further, only about 17 per cent of Americans surveyed in 2025 say they are more optimistic about AI than cautious. Already, the potential risks of unscrupulous use of these tools and the absence of any global framework are being studied and shared by industry experts and institutions like the European Parliament, IEEE, UK Government, IBM, National Institutes of Health (NIH), and many others.

The NIH study flags the potential for

AI errors to cause patient harm, issues of data privacy and security, and use in ways that may worsen social and health inequalities—either by incorporating existing human biases and patterns of discrimination into automated algorithms or by reinforcing inequalities in access to healthcare. One example of harm accentuated by incomplete or biased data was the development of an AI-driven pulse oximeter that overestimated blood oxygen levels in patients with darker skin, resulting in the undertreatment of hypoxia. It suggests that the health community has demonstrated its ability to shape public and political opinion about existential threats in the past. Just as the International Physicians for the Prevention of Nuclear War were awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1985 for assembling principled, authoritative, and evidence-based arguments about the threats of nuclear war, the study suggests the same approach should be adopted for AI in healthcare and medicine.

Armed with existing and evolving risk parameters, sovereign Indian models like Sarvam AI have indigenously developed LLM models, speech, vision, and translation systems in most of the 22 Indian languages using open-source data. The founders, Dr Pratyush Kumar and Dr Vivek Raghavan, have built the platform from scratch in an attempt to make AI accessible, scalable, and affordable for every Indian. This experiment has shown that India has achieved 'proof of concept'; from here, the challenge is to move towards 'proof of scale', suitable for the third-largest economy in the world. There is also Emergent AI, founded by Madhav and Mukund Jha, which designs apps, websites, SaaS tools, customised agents, and system integrations. Within two months of its launch in the summer of 2024, Emergent had 7 million users due to production-ready coding that can be owned or modified by users. It is expected to touch 1 billion users by the end of this year.

These are the beacons that could make the dream of a modern, AI-driven India come true. In fact, the volatility and fluidity of the international job market are likely to result in a surge of ideas and talent. AI can be a game-changer if deployed in agriculture, agroforestry, marine products, and other industrial goods in incremental steps, considering the environmental costs posed by vast energy requirements. The AI invasion by big tech must be tempered by indigenous models that uplift the average Indian.

Views expressed are personal

UNCHECKED
SCALE



PAAVNI JAIN & SPRIHA BHANDARI

BOTH WRITERS ARE ASSISTANT DIRECTORS, CYRIL SHROFF CENTRE FOR AI, LAW AND REGULATION AT O.P. JINDAL GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

Artificial intelligence is no longer just innovation—it is infrastructure, and infrastructure demands governance before consequences become irreversible

AI Beyond Regulatory Reach?

Competitive pressure, weak regulation and rapid innovation are pushing AI beyond existing legal frameworks, raising urgent questions about oversight and control

We may be approaching a moment where artificial intelligence is no longer simply an innovation cycle. It is becoming infrastructure. And infrastructure alters the tempo of society. When Anthropic revised its Responsible Scaling Policy and reworked an earlier commitment not to advance more powerful systems without specified safety conditions, it did spark concern. Not because companies should not compete. Not because innovation must wait indefinitely for regulators. But because the justification was telling. Senior leadership explicitly referenced competitive pressure and the absence of binding regulation as part of the context for the change (Time, "Anthropic Drops Flagship Safety Pledge"; Anthropic Responsible Scaling Policy v3).

That is not a moral failure. It is a market design problem.

Around the same time, Anthropic launched a Substack newsletter for Claude 3 Opus, a retired frontier model, accompanied by public discussion of "retirement" processes for advanced systems (The Verge, "Anthropic gives its retired Claude AI a Substack"). There is something intellectually fascinating about that move. Software does not retire in the way industrial machines once did. It is archived, reactivated, and repurposed. Its outputs become narrative. Its lifecycle extends beyond product deployment into something closer to institutional presence. Questions of authorship, attribution, and intellectual property re-emerge in unfamiliar ways when model outputs are framed as serialised essays rather than ephemeral prompts.

Taken together, these developments raise a larger question.

Are we ready? Frontier artificial intelligence and law increasingly feel like a speed differential joke. Capability scales rapidly through compute, data, and architectural innovation. Legal systems, by design, move through consultation, legislation, interpretation, and enforcement. The gap between those tempos is widening.

The real issue is not whether Anthropic, OpenAI, or any individual firm cares about safety. The issue is whether our technological architecture is



While the European Union's AI Act introduces rules for high-risk systems, most countries lack binding frameworks for frontier AI

designed for a world in which capability scales at this velocity.

In other sectors, once certain thresholds are crossed, governance changes. Commercial aviation operates under certification and airworthiness regimes administered by public authorities. Pharmaceutical products cannot reach the market without phased clinical trials and regulatory approval. Large financial institutions that become systemically significant face enhanced prudential supervision and capital requirements.

Thresholds matter because scale produces externalities that have a far-reaching societal impact. In artificial intelligence, elements of threshold governance are emerging but remain fragmented. The European Union's AI Act introduces obligations for general-purpose AI models with systemic risk, including enhanced transparency and evaluation requirements. Yet globally harmonised definitions of frontier capability do not exist. The compute scale does not, in most jurisdictions, automatically trigger an independent audit. Decisions about pausing development or redefining acceptable risk largely remain internal to firms through voluntary frameworks such as Anthropic's Responsible Scaling Policy or OpenAI's Preparedness Framework.

This is not an argument for bureaucratising every innovation. Technology has historically moved faster than regulation. As it should. Exploration and discovery require room to experiment.

But when exploration begins to alter the technosocial and technological paradigm itself, the absence of clearly articulated capability thresholds becomes more than regulatory delay. It becomes a structural gap.

If companies slow down unilaterally, they risk losing competitive ground. If they accelerate in a regulatory vacuum, they reshape the terrain before democratic institutions have articulated the terms of that reshaping. And with respect to GenAI, we must remember that it was never just about chat interfaces. It is already reshaping knowledge production, creative industries, research workflows, administrative processes, and decision-making infrastructures. The trajectory extends well beyond conversational tools.

If artificial intelligence is moving from product to infrastructure at exponential speed, are we building technological architecture in time?

This question becomes more urgent when we recognise that 'we' encompasses vastly different capacities and constraints. The Global North shapes AI development while often externalising its environmental costs to the Global South. Meanwhile, developing nations face the challenge of building both technological and regulatory infrastructure simultaneously, often with fewer resources to influence the trajectory of systems that will nonetheless reshape their societies.

Views expressed are personal



WHO SAID
WHAT

Joe Kent
@joe kent16jan19

After much reflection, I have decided to resign from my position as Director of the National Counterterrorism Center, effective today. I cannot in good conscience support the ongoing war in Iran. Iran posed no imminent threat to our nation, and it is clear that we started this war due to pressure from Israel and its powerful American lobby. It has been an honor serving under POTUS and leading the professionals at NCTC. May God bless America.

Sonam Wangchuk
@Wangchuk66

I have not stepped away from activism. My commitment to Ladakh remains unchanged. But activism must serve a larger purpose: a just, lasting future for Ladakh. It will require clarity, unity, and sincere dialogue. Our struggle has always been for Ladakh's protection, dignity, and long-term wellbeing and shall continue to be!



AROUND 250 PEOPLE WERE INJURED IN ATTACK

Afghan govt says 400 killed in Pakistani strikes on hospital

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan overnight carried out “precision airstrikes” targeting what it described as terrorists and their support infrastructure locations across Afghanistan, but the Afghan government accused Islamabad of bombing a rehabilitation hospital in Kabul, killing at least 400 people.

The latest strikes came as Operation Ghazab lil Haq, launched on February 26, continued, according to Pakistan’s Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. Pakistan launched the operation in response to alleged attacks by the Afghan Taliban forces along the 2,600-km-long border.

“Pakistan’s Armed Forces successfully carried out precision airstrikes on the night of 16 March as a part of Operation Ghazab Lil Haq, targeting Afghan Taliban regime terrorism sponsoring military installations in Kabul and Nangarhar,” Information Minister Attaullah Tarar said in a post on X.

He claimed that the technical support infrastructure and ammunition storage facilities at two locations in Kabul were effectively destroyed. “The visible secondary detonations after the strikes clearly indicate the presence of



A man walks past damaged structures at the site of an airstrike, in Kabu on Tuesday AP/PTI

large ammunition depots,” he added.

He claimed four Afghan Taliban regime “terrorism sponsoring” military sites were also struck in Nangarhar, destroying associated logistics, ammunition and technical infrastructure.

However, Deputy Spokesman of the Afghan Taliban-led government, Hamdullah Fitrat, said that Monday night’s bombardment by Pakistan targeted a drug rehabilitation centre in the Afghan capital, resulting in the death of at least 400

people. He said 250 others were injured.

In a post on X, Fitrat said the strike destroyed large sections of the hospital and rescue teams were trying to recover the bodies from the rubble.

Citing health officials at the hospital, TOLONews Tuesday reported that more than 50 bodies are still believed to be trapped under the debris as rescue operations continue.

The airstrike destroyed five blocks of the rehabilitation compound, where up to 3,000

patients were receiving treatment, it said.

Deputy Interior Minister Muhammad Nabi Omari, who visited the site, said that Pakistan “has undertaken a project to kill Afghans.”

Zabihullah Mujahid, the spokesperson for the Afghan government, said his country will respond forcefully to Pakistan’s aggression.

Tarar, however, claimed that Pakistan “precisely targeted military installations and terrorist support infrastructure,” including technical

Highlights

- » The latest strikes came as Operation Ghazab lil Haq was launched on February 26
- » Afghanistan says it will respond forcefully to Pakistan’s aggression
- » ‘The visible secondary detonations after the strikes clearly indicate the presence of large ammunition depots’

» OVER 50 BODIES ARE STILL BELIEVED TO BE TRAPPED UNDER THE DEBRIS’

Top US counterterrorism official resigns over Iran war

According to Joe Kent, Tehran posed no imminent threat

WASHINGTON: Joe Kent, the director of the National Counterterrorism Centre, announced his resignation on Tuesday, saying he “cannot in good conscience” back the Trump administration’s war in Iran.

Kent said on social media Iran “posed no imminent threat to our nation, and it is clear that we started this war due to pressure from Israel and its powerful American lobby.”

There was no immediate comment from the White House.

Kent, a former political candidate with connections to right-wing extremists, was confirmed to his post last July on a 52-44 vote.

As head of the National Counterterrorism Centre, he was in charge of an agency tasked with analysing and detecting terrorist threats.

Before entering President



Joe Kent, the director of the National Counterterrorism Centre

Donald Trump’s administration, Kent ran two unsuccessful campaigns for Congress in Washington state. He also served in the military, seeing 11 deployments as a Green Beret, followed by work at the CIA.

Democrats strongly opposed Kent’s confirmation, pointing to his past ties to far-

right figures and conspiracy theories. During his 2022 congressional campaign, Kent paid Graham Jorgensen, a member of the far-right military group the Proud Boys, for consulting work. He also worked closely with Joey Gibson, the founder of the Christian nationalist group Patriot Prayer, and attracted support from a variety of far-right figures.

During his Senate confirmation hearing, Kent also refused to distance himself from a conspiracy theory that federal agents instigated the January 6, 2021, attack at the Capitol, as well as false claims that Trump, a Republican, won the 2020 election over Democrat Joe Biden.

Democrats grilled Kent on his participation in a group chat on Signal that was used by Trump’s national security team to discuss sensitive military plans.

AGENCIES

Nigeria: Suicide bombings killed at least 23 people

MAIDUGURI: At least 23 people were killed and more than 100 wounded in suspected suicide bombings Monday night that targeted Maiduguri city in north-eastern Nigeria, police said Tuesday.

It was one of the deadli-

est attacks in the conflict-battered city in recent history.

Residents and emergency services earlier told The Associated Press that three explosions were reported in crowded places in Maiduguri, the capital of Borno state.

AGENCIES

Israel says it killed top Iranian security official, Basij force chief



DUBAI: Israel’s defence minister said Tuesday that the military killed top Iranian security official Ali Larjani in an overnight strike. The military also announced it killed Gen. Gholam Reza Soleimani, the head of the Revolutionary Guard’s all-volunteer Basij force.

Iranian state media did not immediately confirm either death. Also on Tuesday, a drone attack in the United Arab Emirates sparked a fire at an oil tank farm in Fujairah, an emirate on the country’s east coast with the Gulf of Oman that has been repeatedly targeted, the state-run WAM news agency reported. It said no one was injured in the blast.

The Israeli military also said Tuesday it had launched new attacks across Tehran and Beirut, with the strikes on the Lebanese capital targeting Hezbollah militants.

On Monday, US President Donald Trump said “numerous countries” have told him “they’re on the way” to help police the Strait of Hormuz. But he also suggested some countries’ reluctance showed a lack of reciprocity in defense agreements with the United States.

The war has killed at least 1,300 people in Iran, at least 850 in Lebanon and 12 in Israel, according to officials in those countries.

AGENCIES

Zelenskyy to discuss Russia-Ukraine war with British leader, NATO chief

LONDON: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy was due in London on Tuesday for talks with UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer, the British government said, as European countries look to keep international attention on Russia’s invasion of Ukraine, while the unfolding Iran war engages world leaders.

Starmer’s office said that NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte will also join the meeting at 10 Downing St. to discuss peace-making efforts in Ukraine and “the need to maintain sanctions pressure on Russia.”

The meeting comes days after the US temporarily waived some Russian oil

“ZELENSKY CRITICISED US’ MOVE TO EASE SANCTIONS, SAYING IT WOULD PROVIDE A WINDFALL FOR MOSCOW TO KEEP UP ITS ATTACKS ON UKRAINE”

sanctions in a bid to ease pressure on global supplies triggered by the war in the Middle East, which was sparked by the joint US-Israeli strikes on Iran starting on February 28.

Zelenskyy criticised

Washington’s move to ease sanctions, saying it would provide a windfall for Moscow to keep up its attacks on Ukraine.

US President Donald Trump says he wants to secure a peace deal that ends Europe’s biggest conflict since World War II and has rattled the continent’s leaders, who reckon that Russia could pose a credible security threat to the European Union by the end of the decade.

But US-brokered talks between delegations from Moscow and Kyiv, which so far have yielded no significant progress on key issues, have lost momentum amid the Middle East conflict.

AGENCIES

UN report raises ‘ethnic cleansing’ concerns in Palestinians’ displacement in West Bank

GENEVA: The UN human rights chief’s office expressed concerns about possible “ethnic cleansing” in a new report on Tuesday, saying that Israel has accelerated the expansion of settlements in large parts of the occupied West Bank and the forced displacement of more than 36,000 Palestinians.

The report from the office of Volker Turk, the UN high commissioner for human rights, covers a yearlong period through the end of October. It decries increased violence by Israeli settlers and security forces against Palestinians in the area.

Turk alleged that Israeli authorities were “playing the



An Israeli army strike hits next to a tent camp after residents were given a warning to evacuate before the strike in Gaza City AP/FILE PHOTO

central role in directing, participating in or enabling this conduct,” and the report

denounced harassment, intimidation and destruction of farmland and homes of Palestinians.

China to provide humanitarian aid to Iran, Lebanon, other West Asian nations

BEIJING: China on Tuesday said it will provide emergency humanitarian assistance to Iran, Lebanon and two other West Asian countries hit hard by the ongoing conflict in the region.

Speaking at a media briefing, Chinese foreign ministry spokesperson Lin Jian said that

Beijing has decided to provide emergency humanitarian aid to Iran, Jordan, Lebanon, and Iraq in the hope of easing the humanitarian plight faced by local people.

“The ongoing conflict has inflicted excruciating humanitarian disasters on (the) people of Iran and other regional

Much of the displacement of thousands has taken place in the northern West Bank, where Israel launched a broad military offensive in early 2025

Much of the displacement of thousands has taken place in the northern West Bank, where Israel launched a broad military offensive in early 2025.

AGENCIES

Air pollution from burning oil depots, bombed buildings pose health threats

PHOENIX: The waves of US and Israeli bomb strikes in Tehran and Beirut, and Iran’s missile and drone attacks on neighbouring countries in response, are damaging more than buildings – they are sending toxic debris into the air in cities that are home to millions of people.

Military strikes have hit Iran’s missile stockpiles, nuclear facilities and oil refineries. When a strike set fire to an oil depot, it sent toxic black clouds billowing over Tehran and created oily rain that settled on buildings, cars and people. Residents described having headaches and difficulty breathing.

As a chemical and environmental engineer who studies the behaviour and effects of airborne particles, I have been following the damage reports to understand the health risks residents are facing as toxic materials get into the air.

The risks come from many sources, from heavy metals in the munitions themselves to the materials sent airborne by what they blow apart.

The invisible enemy during war: Air pollution

A disaster’s effects on air quality and public health depend in large part on what is being destroyed.

The terrorist attacks on New York City’s World Trade Centre on Sept. 11, 2001, were localised, but they ejected massive bursts of pollutants into the air. These included gases such as volatile organic compounds and particulates – often called aerosols – containing a myriad of substances, such as dust,



Representational Image

Takeaways

- » The risks come from many sources, from heavy metals in the munitions themselves to the materials sent airborne by what they blow apart
- » A disaster’s effects on air quality and public health depend in large part on what is being destroyed

polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons, metals, asbestos and polychlorinated biphenyls.

These pollutants can harm the lungs, making breathing difficult, and worsen cardiovascular problems, contributing to heart attacks, among other health damage.

Tiny particles smaller than 2.5 micrometres, called PM2.5, are especially harmful because they can travel deep into the human respiratory system. But larger particles can also bring major airborne health risks. When buildings are heavily

damaged or collapse, the rubble often contains crushed concrete, gypsum and carcinogenic fibrous materials, such as asbestos.

Even after the initial dust settles, wind and other disturbances, including efforts to find survivors or clear the rubble, can send those materials back into the air, putting more people at risk.

Many rescue and recovery workers who responded to the World Trade Centre collapse in 2001 developed chronic respiratory problems. That’s also a risk for people searching for survivors in bombed buildings after military strikes and later when cleaning up the debris.

Fires create additional hazards as vehicles, buildings and the chemicals and other materials in them burn. The January 2025 fires in Los Angeles sent a stew of dangerous particles and gases into the lower atmosphere.

Munitions and oil facilities

Military attacks degrade air quality in other ways. The Gaza Strip, Iraq, Kuwait, Ukraine and most recently Iran and surrounding countries have all

faced extensive damage from munitions, which contain toxic materials. Bombs and artillery often contain explosives and heavy metals, such as lead and mercury, which also contaminate soil, water and the environment.

When oil storage facilities and pipelines are damaged, they emit an especially harmful cocktail of pollutants. This chemical blend includes airborne soot particles, which darken the sky and contribute to the “black rain” observed in Iran.

During the Gulf War in 1991, downwind countries experienced similar polluted rain as Kuwait’s oil fields burned. The US Department of Defence found that the smoke plumes contained sulfur dioxide and nitrogen oxides, among other gases and soot.

The severe consequences of environmental pollution during wars prompted the US National Academies of Science, Engineering, and Medicine to publish a series of reports on Gulf War military veterans’ health, starting in the early 2000s.

Getting pollution out of the air

Nature, including rain and wind, can help reduce the pollution levels in the air.

Rain helps pull particles out of the air, depositing them back on the ground and surfaces. The raindrops form around particles and also collect more particles as they fall. However, rain has occurred only sporadically since the military attacks began in Iran.

AGENCIES

US-IRAN WAR

Rejected by NATO, most allies to join mission to secure Hormuz: Trump

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump on Tuesday said NATO and most other allies have rejected his calls to help secure the Strait of Hormuz as the war with Iran rages on.

Trump, who has been pressing allies to help safeguard the critical waterway, fumed that the US is not getting support “despite the fact that almost every country strongly agreed with what we are doing, and that Iran cannot” be allowed to secure a nuclear weapon.

Iran’s attacks on Gulf nations and its grip on the Strait of Hormuz, through which a fifth of the world’s oil is transported, have sparked increasing concerns of a global energy crisis and are unnerving the world economy.

A handful of ships have crossed through the strait, and Iran has said the vital waterway technically remains open – just not for the United States, Israel and their allies. About 20 vessels have been struck since the war began.

With oil prices rising,



US President Donald Trump holds a signed executive order regarding a task force on fraud, in the Oval Office of the White House in Washington AP/PTI

About 20 vessels have been struck since the war began

Trump said he had demanded that roughly a half-dozen countries send warships to ensure ships can pass through the Strait of Hormuz.

But his appeals brought no immediate commitments, with many saying they are hesitant to get involved in a war with no defined exit plan and sceptical that they could do more than the US Navy.

AGENCIES

World Briefs

XI’S BOOKS BURNT IN NEPAL COLLEGE; CHINA LODGES PROTEST

KATHMANDU: Multiple copies of a book by Chinese President Xi Jinping were burnt at a college in Nepal, leading to the Chinese mission here issuing a diplomatic note to the Home Ministry, officials said on Tuesday. According to media reports, old books were burnt at the Manmohan Technical Institute in Koshi province’s Morang district on Saturday to make space in the college library. These included several copies of ‘The Governance of China’ written by Xi, the reports said, quoting the college administration. “We have heard through social media that some books, including one ‘The Governance of China’ written by Xi, were burnt in the Manmohan Technical Institute, and the Chinese Embassy in Kathmandu expressed concern over the incident through the Ministry of Foreign Affairs,” Home Ministry spokesperson Ananda Kale told PTI.

PAKISTAN DAY MILITARY PARADE CANCELLED AMID GULF CRISIS

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Tuesday announced to cancel the annual Pakistan Day military parade due to the ongoing Gulf situation and its economic and security spinoff impact. The Pakistan Day parade is held on March 23 to commemorate the resolution passed by the All India Muslim League in 1940 in its meeting in Lahore, demanding separate homeland for Muslims in India. The Pakistan government announced a slew of austerity measures last week to save fuel due to disruptions caused by the conflict in West Asia.

Health insurance priority for govt, to cover all by 2033: Sitharaman

The insurance sector is expanding & during 2024-25 it covered 58 crore lives in the country, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Health insurance is a priority for this government and it is expected that the country will have insurance for all by 2033, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday.

Replying to supplementary queries during Question Hour, she said the insurance sector is expanding and during 2024-25 it covered 58 crore lives in the country. "Health insurance is a priority for this government. In fact, we are hoping that by 2033 we will have insurance cover for all," she said.

In December 2025, the minister said the government came up with a Bill to hike FDI in the insurance sector with an aim to increase its penetration and deepen the market.

She said insurance regulator IRDAI notified rules for the rural social sector and third-party obligations in 2024 to increase penetration in rural areas. "...if you are looking at insurance in general, we have a challenge in that," she said adding the per capita premium is only \$97 whereas the global average is \$943.

"While penetration remains low, the government is actively bridging this gap through tar-



In December 2025, the minister said the govt came up with a Bill to hike FDI in the insurance sector with an aim to increase its penetration and deepen the market

geted reforms and affordability measures. Health insurance is now a clear priority with GST exemption on individual premiums, expansion of coverage and strong regulatory push driving the momentum," the finance minister said.

Noting that health insurance is actually rapidly expanding as a market, she said, "today the sector has already scaled significantly, reaching Rs 1,17,505 crore in 2024-25 and covering 58 crore lives, with balanced contributions from public, pri-

Highlights

- » IRDAI notified rules for rural social sector, third-party obligations in 2024 to hike penetration in rural areas, she said
- » While penetration remains low, the govt is actively bridging this gap through targeted reforms and affordability measures
- » Health insurance sector has already scaled significantly, reaching Rs 1,17,505 cr in 2024-25

ivate and standalone insurers." "Public sector insurers particularly through health premiums, give cover of worth Rs 42,420 crore, private sector does Rs 37,752 crore and standalone health insurance companies are doing Rs 37,331 crore," Sitharaman said, adding that for the poorest of the poor there is PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana.

Most importantly, she said, PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana offers protection at just Rs 436 per year for Rs 2 lakh cover, ensuring even the most vulner-

able are not left behind. "With 26.79 crore enrolments and proven responsiveness during COVID, India is steadily building a more inclusive, accessible, and resilient health insurance ecosystem," she noted.

The minister said private sector insurance companies as well as public sector companies are all very systematically and methodically regulated by the insurance regulator. "If there are any wrongdoings by insurance companies, the regulator acts upon them." In the last three years, there have been several instances where insurance companies, when found in violation of the law, have been taken to task, she said adding fines of Rs 1-2 crore were imposed on many private insurers.

"If there is undue influence by insurance companies using their dominant position, or when they make false and misleading claims, misrepresent facts, omit key features while selling insurance, or fail to ensure suitability of the policy, all such acts of omission and commission are acted upon."

"For instance, in 2023-24, a penalty of Rs 2 crore was levied on Reliance General Insurance Company for unfair business practices. Similarly, penalties have been imposed on other

companies including Bajaj Finance Ltd - Rs 2 crore, HDFC Life Insurance - Rs 2 crore, SBI Life Insurance - Rs 1 crore, and Royal Sundaram General Insurance - Rs 1 crore," she informed the House.

In her written reply to the question, the finance minister said, "In India, as informed by Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI), for FY 2024-25, there were 251.85 lakh individual health insurance policies, which include family members as well, covering 6.01 crore people. Further, there are 13.05 lakh group health insurance policies, covering 27.51 crore members."

She said Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) provides health insurance coverage of Rs 5 lakh per family per year for secondary and tertiary care hospitalization to 12 crore families, constituting the bottom 40 per cent of India's population.

"In October 2024, the scheme was further expanded to cover 6 crore senior citizens of age 70 years and above belonging to 4.5 crore families irrespective of their socio-economic status. As on 28.02.2026, a total of 43.52 crore Ayushman cards have been created across the country.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark Sensex climbed 567 points and Nifty closed near 23,600 in their second consecutive day of gains on Tuesday, boosted by a rally in metal and auto shares and a positive trend in global markets.

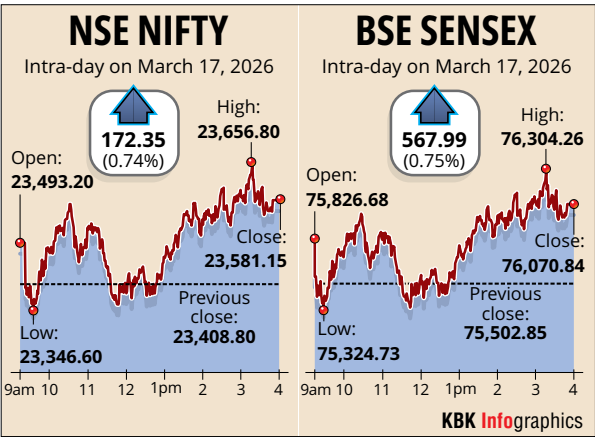
The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 567.99 points or 0.75 per cent to settle at 23,581.15. During the day, it surged 801.41 points or 1.06 per cent to 26,304.26.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 172.35 points or 0.74 per cent to end at 23,581.15.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Eternal surged the most by 5.70 per cent. Tata Steel, Mahindra & Mahindra, Bharat Electronics, Larsen & Toubro, Bharti Airtel and Maruti were also among the major gainers.

Infosys, Bajaj Finance, ITC, Tata Consultancy Services and HCL Tech were among the biggest losers.

"The market extended its gains, driven largely by bargain hunting by domestic investors. Cyclical sectors such as autos, metals, and financials continued to be leaders rebounding after being among the worst affected during the sell-off. However, it is premature to conclude that this reversal is sustainable in the short term, as war-related uncertainties persist," Vinod Nair, Head of



A total of 2,362 stocks advanced, 1,892 declined and 157 remained unchanged the BSE

Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said.

The BSE MidCap Select Index jumped 0.86 per cent and SmallCap Select Index climbed 0.67 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, metal surged 2.81 per cent, followed by auto (2.05 per cent), realty (1.79 per cent), commodities (1.69 per cent), consumer discretionary (1.54 per cent), industrials (1.54 per cent), capital goods (1.40 per cent), telecommunication (1.24 per cent) and Bankex (0.90 per

cent). IT, FMCG and BSE Focused IT were the laggards.

A total of 2,362 stocks advanced, while 1,892 declined and 157 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The rupee declined 12 paise to settle at an all-time low of 92.40 against the US dollar on Tuesday, pressured by rising crude oil prices and sustained outflow of foreign funds amid the West Asia crisis.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.44 per cent to \$102.7 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 9,365.52 crore on Monday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), however, bought stocks worth Rs 12,593.36 crore.

Food processing roadmap key for nutrition security by 2047: Paswan

NEW DELHI: Union Minister of Food Processing Industries, Chirag Paswan on Tuesday emphasised the need for a roadmap in the food processing and nutraceutical sector in the country, saying that the sector must align itself with the vision of becoming a developed nation by 2047. Addressing ASSOCHAM's "NutriBharat 2026: National Conference on the Role of Nutraceuticals and Functional Foods in Strengthening Nutrition Security," he said the sector must set clear milestones for next 5-10 years while working collaboratively with policymakers & regulators to unlock its full potential.

"India has successfully moved from food scarcity to food security. The next frontier is nutrition security, ensuring that our future generations are healthy and free from malnutri-



tion," Paswan said. He emphasized that the food processing industry has a crucial role to play in delivering safe, nutritious, and high-quality food products to consumers.

Highlighting the importance of maintaining global standards, the minister urged industry players to ensure that quality is never compromised, noting that even a single rejected consignment at an international port can dam-

age India's reputation built over decades. He also stressed the need for innovation, responsible manufacturing practices, and stronger collaboration between industry, regulators, and research institutions.

He further noted that India has the potential to emerge as a "global food basket," supported by its strong agricultural base, growing food processing capacity, and expanding global trade partnerships.

Parl panel asks MoSPI to ensure optimum use of funds, go for supplementary demands if needed

In its report on Demands for Grants (2026-27), the panel noted that MoSPI received Rs 4,522.25 cr against its projected requirement of Rs 5,826.11 cr

NEW DELHI: The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance has asked the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) to ensure optimal use of allocated funds and seek supplementary grants if required.

In its report on Demands for Grants (2026-27), the panel noted that MoSPI received Rs 4,522.25 crore against its projected requirement of Rs 5,826.11 crore.

The ministry flagged that reduced funding could affect key schemes such as the Support for Statistical Strengthening (SSS), including delays in IT infrastructure procurement, fieldwork mobilisation

Panel warned that funding constraints may impact data granularity at sub-national levels

and training in the first half of 2026-27.

The committee warned that funding constraints may impact data granularity at sub-national levels and slow digital transformation of statistical systems. It noted higher projections were due to the revamp of SSS, preparations for the 8th Economic Census, and multiple surveys including PLFS, Household

Income Survey and AIDIS, along with digital initiatives like the Data Innovation Lab.

While advising the ministry to continue planned programmes, the panel recommended seeking additional funds through supplementary demands if needed.

Emphasising the importance of data in policymaking, the committee suggested developing an integrated digital dashboard to provide standardised, verified and regularly updated data from ministries and agencies in a user-friendly format.

It also urged expediting the proposed National Child Survey under Mission Vatsalya in

coordination with the Ministry of Women and Child Development, along with creating a child wellbeing dashboard and National Child Index. Engagement with states, panchayats and urban bodies was recommended for localised data collection.

The panel flagged issues in the MPLAD portal, recommending improvements for real-time tracking and smoother onboarding of implementing agencies. On project monitoring, it suggested a dynamic escalation matrix, with persistent project delays flagged to the Cabinet Secretariat or PMO for review under forums like PRAGATI.

Silver jumps ₹6K, gold rises to ₹1,61,300 per 10 grams

NEW DELHI: Precious metal prices rebounded by up to 2 per cent, with silver gaining by Rs 6,000 to Rs 2.62 lakh per kilogram, and gold rose to Rs 1.61 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, according to the All India Sarafa Association.

The white metal increased by Rs 6,000, or 2.34 per cent, to Rs 2,62,500 per kilogram. Gold of 99.9 per cent purity in the bullion market also snapped its three-day losing streak, rising by Rs 1,050, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 1,61,300 per 10 grams.

In the global market, spot gold was trading marginally lower at \$5,003.68 per ounce, and silver also went lower by 0.35 per cent, to \$80.46 per ounce.

Air India to operate 36 additional flights to Europe, Canada during March 19-28

NEW DELHI: Air India will operate 36 additional flights to destinations in Europe and North America between March 19 and 28 amid the West Asia conflict impacting travel plans of people.



In a statement on Tuesday, the airline said it would operate additional services on Delhi-London (Heathrow), Mumbai-London (Heathrow), Delhi-Frankfurt, Delhi-Zurich & Delhi-Toronto routes.

"These flights will add 10,012 seats on the five routes, further boosting capacity and

providing more choice to travellers when travel options remain limited," it said.

The West Asia conflict involving the US, Israel and Iran that started on February 28 has disrupted flight operations, and airlines have curtailed their services in the region.

Natural diet, gut health and balanced nutrition key to longevity and healthy ageing: Experts

NEW DELHI: The Illness to Wellness Foundation, in association with the Celiac Society of India, hosted an interactive session, "The Longevity Blueprint - Gut Health and InflammAgeing," at the India International Centre, highlighting the role of diet and lifestyle in healthy ageing.

Moderated by Dr. Arjun Dang, the discussion brought together experts from geriatrics, psychiatry, nutrition and Ayurveda to examine links between gut health, chronic inflammation and longevity. Speakers discussed "inflammAgeing," a low-grade inflammation that accelerates ageing and contributes to lifestyle diseases.



Nutritionist Ishi Khosla emphasised that balanced, home-based diets can improve gut health and reduce inflammation. Dr. Prasun Chatterjee stressed that longevity is about living healthier, noting the gut's central role and the adequacy of a balanced Indian diet

over supplements.

Dr. Aarti Midha highlighted the gut-brain axis, linking digestion to mental health, while Dr. Partap Chauhan underlined Ayurveda's focus on balance for sustained vitality. Dr. Pankaj Verma said biological age is shaped by lifestyle,

stress and inflammation, and can be improved with early interventions.

Anil Rajput, Chairperson, Advisory Council, Illness to Wellness Foundation, said, "When we neglect our wellness today, we inevitably end up spending time managing illness tomorrow... The real foundation of long-term health lies in balanced nutrition, traditional food wisdom and healthy lifestyle practices."

Experts recommended fibre-rich and fermented foods, diverse plant-based diets and periodic fasting to support gut health. The session concluded that consistent lifestyle choices are key to long-term health and wellbeing.

India central to global green transition, says Jitendra Singh

'India must align with global benchmarks & priorities if it seeks to play a defining role in evolving economic order'

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: India's role will be unique in shaping the global green transition, Union Minister of State for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh said on Tuesday, asserting that "the world cannot turn green unless India turns green."

Addressing the valedictory session of the 10th Sustainable Business Futures Summit organised by FICCI, the Minister underscored the need for convergence among stakeholders to drive sustainable growth. He said India must align with global benchmarks and priori-

ties if it seeks to play a defining role in the evolving economic order.

Dr. Singh pointed to an imminent "paradigm shift" in the global economy, moving away from conventional production systems towards regeneration, recycling, and genetic processes. "We need to sustain economic growth while consistently moving up and ensuring adherence to global norms," he said.

Highlighting priority areas, he called for a coordinated push in energy system innovation, particularly next-generation energy storage and grid



management. He also emphasised the importance of climate modelling and risk analytics, alongside advancements in materials, construction tech-

nologies, and digital infrastructure. "We cannot be working in silos," he said, stressing that the transition to green infrastructure must be "seamless,

uneventful and optimum."

The Minister noted that India's domestic infrastructure strategy already integrates climate considerations across sectors, including renewable energy expansion, green hydrogen, electrification of transport, and sustainable urban planning.

Dr. Singh also drew attention to India's startup ecosystem, which now comprises over two lakh ventures generating significant employment. "Nearly 50% of these startups come from tier-two cities, and about 40% are women-led," he said, describing it as a trans-

formative shift in the country's innovation landscape.

Cristiano Massimo Pasini of UNIDO highlighted that industrial transformation is inherently ecosystem-driven. "The quality of infrastructure, institutions, and linkages determines long-term competitiveness," he said, adding that sustainability must be embedded into production systems rather than retrofitted later.

The summit concluded with a consensus on the need for integrated, forward-looking strategies to align economic growth with environmental responsibility.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



The Reserve Bank of India has been selected for the 'Initiative of the Year Award' by Central Banking, London, UK. The recognition is for launching the '.bank.in' domain, making India the first country globally to mandate a secure and exclusive Internet domain for the banking system. The transition enhances consumer confidence, helps reduce digital payment frauds and strengthens financial stability. This has been implemented through involvement of multiple stakeholders, including the Government of India, NIXI, IDBRT, and banks.



NMDC Ltd and GMDC Ltd signed an MoU to explore collaborations in Rare Earth Elements and associated minerals on Monday. This partnership paves the way for exploration of rare earth deposits in the country, along with the expansion of R&D capabilities and carbon conscious initiatives in this sub-sector. The MoU was signed in the presence of Amitava Mukherjee, CMD, NMDC and Roopwant Singh, IAS, Managing Director, GMDC accompanied by Senior Officers from both sides at the NMDC Headquarters in Hyderabad. Effective from March 16, 2026 for a period of two years, the MoU recommends the formation of a Steering Committee and Working Group to evaluate and enrich the proposed collaboration.

India, EU discuss energy security amid escalating West Asia conflict

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday that both sides underlined the need for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve the crisis

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The escalating conflict in West Asia and its ripple effects on global energy security figured prominently in External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar's high-level talks with his counterparts from the 27 European Union (EU) member states in Brussels.

A day after the talks, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday that both sides underlined the need for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve the crisis.

Global oil and gas prices have surged after Iran virtually blocked the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, that handles roughly 20 per cent of global oil and LNG.

The West Asia has been a major source of India's energy procurement.

Jaishankar visited the Belgian capital at the invitation of EU foreign and security policy chief Kaja Kallas to join a meeting of the Foreign Affairs Council, which comprises the foreign ministers of the bloc.

It was the first high-level visit from India to the Brussels-headquartered EU after the two sides firmed up a landmark Free Trade Agreement (FTA) follow-



Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, left, exchanges a handshake with EU High Representative for Foreign Affairs and Security Policy Kaja Kallas during a meeting, in Brussels, Belgium

Global oil & gas prices have surged after Iran virtually blocked the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, that handles roughly 20% of global oil & LNG

ing summit talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the EU leadership in January.

Jaishankar also held separate meetings with European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and his counterparts from EU member states such as Germany and Belgium.

The external affairs minister highlighted the strong momen-

tum following the India-EU Summit in January and called for unlocking the full potential of the FTA, besides deepening defence industrial collaboration and maritime co-operation under the security and defence partnership, the MEA said.

Jaishankar also underlined the need for transform the India-EU Trade and Technol-

Highlights

» Jaishankar visited the Belgian capital at the invitation of EU foreign and security policy chief Kaja Kallas to join a meeting of the Foreign Affairs Council

» It was the first high-level visit from India to the Brussels-headquartered EU after the two sides firmed up a landmark Free Trade Agreement

» The External Affairs Minister also held separate bilateral meetings with his counterparts from Belgium, Cyprus, Germany, Greece and the Netherlands

ogy Council into a more "out-

come driven" forum.

"The external affairs minister urged the EU foreign ministers to realise synergies between India's relations with the European Union and with member states -- a sentiment that was fully reciprocated by his EU counterparts," the MEA said.

It said the ministers also

exchanged views on pressing global challenges, particularly the situation in West Asia including its effects on energy security and underlined the need for dialogue and diplomacy.

"They also discussed the situation in Ukraine and the Indo-Pacific. EAM stressed on the growing convergence between India and the EU in maintaining a stable international order and strengthening multilateralism," the MEA added. On the margins of the Foreign Affairs Council, Jaishankar held a bilateral meeting with Kallas.

"Both sides reaffirmed their shared ambition to further elevate India & EU cooperation to a higher strategic level. They also underlined the importance of regular consultations on key global and regional matters including the Indo-Pacific," the MEA said. Jaishankar also held separate bilateral meetings with his counterparts from Belgium, Cyprus, Germany, Greece and the Netherlands.

"India and EU relations have entered a phase of renewed strategic momentum, with both sides intensifying engagement on implementation of the 'Towards 2030: A Joint India-EU Comprehensive Strategic Agenda,' the MEA said.

Why bank details of deceased can't be disclosed to heirs: SC to Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked the Centre and the Reserve Bank of India why details of the bank accounts of deceased persons could not be disclosed to heirs, and said the government must come up with a policy on the issue.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta was hearing a PIL filed by journalist Sucheta Dalal, seeking a direction to set up a mechanism to inform the legal heirs of deceased depositors about the unclaimed deposits lying dormant in bank accounts.

"Suppose a man has got 10 different accounts in different countries, he dies intestate, how do his heirs get the details? He may not have done the KYC..."

"It's not a question of policy; we are not saying that the transfer is illegal. What we are saying is, what is wrong if we give the information to the legal heirs? You will have to come out with some policy," the bench remarked.

During the hearing, advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for Dalal, submitted that the petitioner has sought directions for making the details of such unclaimed accounts public.

He said the Reserve Bank of India had also recommended the need to have a "Centralised and Searchable Database" so that people can trace the accounts of their deceased parents.

Additional Solicitor General



'What is wrong if we give the information to the legal heirs? You will have to come out with some policy,' the bench remarked

N Venkataraman, appearing for the Centre, said if a genuine heir comes forward, the amount is refunded to them from the Depositor Education and Awareness (DEA) Fund.

The DEA Fund, established by the RBI in 2014, holds unclaimed deposits from commercial and co-operative banks.

The top court asked the Centre and the RBI to file fresh affidavits in the matter and posted the matter for hearing on May 5.

The apex court had earlier asked the Finance Ministry to file its response to the PIL seeking directions to create a centralised database providing information about bank accounts, insurance, deposits and post office funds lying in accounts held by those who are no longer alive.

Key Points

» If a genuine heir comes forward, the amount is refunded to them from DEA Fund, Additional Solicitor General N Venkataraman said

» Established by RBI in 2014, DEA Fund holds unclaimed deposits from commercial and co-operative banks

» The top court asked the Centre and the RBI to file fresh affidavits in the matter and posted the matter for hearing on May 5

The plea has also sought a direction to establish a procedure that eliminates unnecessary litigation while dealing with claims of legal heirs qua bank deposits, insurance, post office funds, etc.

The plea said that the Depositors' Education and Awareness Fund had Rs 39,264.25 crore at the end of March 2021, up from Rs 33,114 crore on 31 March 2020 and a sharp rise from Rs 18,381 crore at the end of March 2019.

The petition stated there is an urgent need to develop a centralised online database under the control of Reserve Bank of India that will provide information about the deceased account holder, including such details as the name, address and last date of transaction by the deceased account holder.

Jio Payments Bank launches UPI cash withdrawals

NEW DELHI: Jio Payments Bank, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Jio Financial Services, has introduced UPI-based cash withdrawal through its business correspondent touchpoints, marking an important step towards strengthening digital payments ecosystem and advancing financial inclusion.

The feature enables customers, particularly in rural and semi-urban areas, to conveniently withdraw cash by simply scanning a UPI QR code and authorising the transaction through their UPI application, eliminating the need for debit cards or access to traditional ATM infrastructure, Jio Financial Services Ltd (JFSL) said in a statement on Tuesday.

By enabling cardless cash withdrawals at business correspondent (BC) touchpoints, the initiative bridges the gap between digital payments and physical cash access, while providing first-time digital users with an assisted and secure way to experience UPI transactions, it added.

Through this initiative, Jio Payments Bank Ltd (JPBL) continues to leverage the digital payments infrastructure and its last-mile BC network to expand accessible banking services, strengthen UPI's reach among cash-dependent segments, and enhance financial inclusion across rural and semi-urban India, it said.

Postal dept launches guaranteed 24-hour, 48-hour delivery services

NEW DELHI: The Department of Posts on Tuesday rolled out three premium services, with 24-hour and 48-hour delivery guarantees for urgent and time-sensitive consignments, as it seeks to reinvent itself against a growing field of courier services that promise delivery within hours.

Launching the services — 24 Speed Post, 24 Speed Post Parcel, and 48 Speed Post — Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia said India Post's revenue growth is encouraging, with a 20 per cent growth in the 11 months of FY26.

Initially, these services are being rolled out in six cities — Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bengaluru, and Hyderabad — with the goal of providing nationwide coverage by March 2027. The department will uti-



Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia

lise dedicated processing and priority air transport to adhere to delivery timelines.

Scindia said the launch marks a moment of renewal for India Post and has outlined a massive underlying opportunity.

The e-commerce market, he said, is set to grow to Rs 30 lakh crore by 2030, almost tripling from Rs 11 lakh crore at present.

"Today, parcels are only 5 per cent of our business. But it

is our common objective that parcel (service) has to become the growth engine of our enterprise. In the 11 months of this year (FY26), the parcel business has grown by over 44 per cent... But we have to push this engine even further. There is no reason why we should not become a full-fledged delivery engine," the minister noted.

The new offerings will feature OTP-verified deliveries and comprehensive end-to-end tracking paired with real-time SMS alerts, according to an official statement.

Businesses will have options of 'Book Now, Pay Later (BNPL)', centralised billing, and API integration. Additionally, free pickup for bulk shipments and a money-back guarantee, in case of a delayed delivery, will also be provided.

Retail participation in G-Secs picks up; secondary market volumes jump 3.7 times in a year: RBI data

MUMBAI: Retail participation in the government bond market is gradually gaining traction, with secondary market activity witnessing a sharp surge, according to the latest RBI Retail Direct data.

Traded volumes in the secondary market segment have risen 3.7 times over the past year on the RBI Retail Direct platform, reflecting growing interest among individual investors in government securities, supported by easier access through the Retail Direct platform and improving liquidity.

Data showed that total traded volume on the RBI Retail Direct platform increased to Rs 8,211.91 crore as on March 16, 2026, from Rs 1,756.08 crore a



year ago.

"The most notable development is the sharp increase in secondary market traded volume. This indicates that retail investors are slowly becoming more comfortable trading government securities rather than limiting themselves only to primary subscriptions," said Venkatakrishnan Srinivasan, founder and managing partner

of Rockfort Fincap LLP.

The central government dated securities accounted for the bulk of trading volumes at Rs 8,059.96 crore, followed by Rs 82.23 crore in state government securities, Rs 59.95 crore in treasury bills, and Rs 9.77 crore in sovereign gold bonds.

The RBI's Retail Direct scheme helps individuals invest in government securities through a direct platform. Srinivasan noted that the relatively lower participation in state government securities is surprising, given that state development loans typically offer a yield spread of 0.50-0.80 per cent over comparable G-Secs, indicating that retail investors may be prioritising

liquidity and visibility over incremental returns.

In the primary market, total subscriptions increased to around Rs 8,414.95 crore from Rs 6,245.18 crore in the year-ago period, with treasury bills accounting for the largest share, reflecting investor preference for shorter-tenor and simpler instruments.

In the last few weeks, the yield on the government securities has been trading on the higher side due to conflict in the Middle East, which led to a sharp surge in crude oil prices in the international market, posing a threat to imported inflation.

Currently, the 10-year benchmark bond yield is trading at 6.7118 per cent.

RBI injects ₹48,014 cr in banking system via 7-day variable rate repo auction

MUMBAI: The RBI on Tuesday injected Rs 48,014 crore in transient liquidity into the banking system through a seven-day variable rate repo (VRR) auction.

These funds were infused at a cut-off rate and weighted average rate of 5.26 per cent, according to the RBI's release.

The liquidity injected was much lower than the notified amount of Rs 1.50 lakh crore, despite the sharp drop in the surplus liquidity in the banking system on account of advance tax payments.

Under the VRR auction, the central bank auctions funds at variable interest rates for a short

period, allowing banks to bid for a certain amount.

Liquidity in the banking system is expected to tighten further after the outflows towards payment of GST, scheduled later this week.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in a surplus of around Rs 75,483.63 crore as of March 16, which is sharply down from Rs 2.08 lakh crore as of March 15, before the advance tax payouts.

RBI has infused Rs 3.50 lakh crore of durable liquidity into the banking system through open market purchase (OMO) of government securities since January 2026.

Maruti gets ₹5,786 crore I-T order



NEW DELHI: Maruti Suzuki India (MSI) on Tuesday said it has received a draft assessment order worth Rs 5,786.4 crore from the income tax authority and the company will challenge the order.

"The company has received a Draft Assessment Order for FY23 wherein certain additions / disallowances amounting to Rs 57,864 million with respect to returned income has been proposed," MSI said in a BSE filing. MSI will file its objections before the dispute resolution panel, it stated.

When contacted over the issue, MSI Senior Executive Officer (Corporate Affairs) Rahul Bharti said: "The draft income tax assessment order about which the company has intimated the stock exchanges is of a routine nature. Such orders arise from time to time, largely on account of interpretation issues."

"In the company's assessment, there is no financial impact, and the matter will be handled through the usual process," he added.

Finalise legal strategy for indirect control model for PSUs: Parl panel to DIPAM

At present, the government must retain at least a 51 per cent stake to maintain public sector undertaking (PSU) status

NEW DELHI: The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance has asked the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) to finalise a clear legal strategy—such as a 'golden share' or indirect control model—to safeguard strategic autonomy in public sector undertakings (PSUs) even if government shareholding drops below 51 per cent.

At present, the government must retain at least a 51 per cent stake to maintain PSU status. The panel noted that alternative mechanisms are being explored to ensure oversight



while enabling disinvestment.

In its 33rd report on Demands for Grants (2026-27), the committee also recommended revamping the MoU framework into a high-performance tool that mandates succession planning and prevents

CLOSER LOOK

» It stressed that CPSEs require strong internal resources to meet their annual capital expenditure target of around Rs 3 lakh crore for sustainable growth

» It further called for a calibrated roadmap for Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) and Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs)

excessive dividend extraction from weakening internal accruals. It stressed that CPSEs require strong internal resources to meet their annual capital expenditure target of around Rs 3 lakh crore for sustainable growth.

The panel, chaired by Bhartruhari Mahtab, urged the Finance Ministry to urgently fill 38 vacant posts in DIPAM through coordination with the Department of Personnel and Training and the Department of Expenditure.

It further called for a calibrated roadmap for Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) and Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs), backed by robust valuation safeguards and transparent oversight.

For the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA), the committee emphasised bridging revenue gaps at the Revised Estimates stage to ensure smooth functioning, staff morale and institutional efficiency.

It recommended close coordination with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to optimise borrowing and adopt

innovative debt-reduction strategies, including shifting towards longer-maturity debt to reduce refinancing risks and free resources for capital investment.

The panel also urged early finalisation of the SME Growth Fund to accelerate funding for MSMEs and recommended a strategic shift in Viability Gap Funding towards new-age and social infrastructure projects.

To boost investor confidence, it highlighted the need to strengthen the PPP ecosystem by leveraging GIFT IFSC and operationalising an International Dispute Resolution

Centre for legal certainty.

It also called for procedural reforms and non-monetary incentives for states, such as technical support and faster clearances, to ensure capital investments translate into technological advancement and long-term economic resilience.

For the Department of Expenditure, the committee recommended expanding the Public Financial Management System (PFMS) to the last mile for better fund tracking and strengthening outcome-based budgeting and internal audits to ensure efficient utilisation of public funds.

AGENCIES



Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd. 4/10, Mythree Tower, Bommanhalli Hosur Main Road Bangalore- 560068

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in this Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Sumeet Kumar Singh/ LBBNG00006010355/ LBBNG00006010356	Schedule 'A' Property All That Piece And Parcel of Western Portion of The Property Bearing Site No.2, Assessment No.9/2, BBMP Khata No.9/2/2, Byatrayanapura Cmc Khata No.1234/9/2/2 Situated At Thindlu Village, Yelahanka Hobli, Bangalore North Taluk, Measuring East To West 25 Feet And North To South (71.6+79) Feet, In All Measuring 2075 Sq. Ft. And Bounded on: East: Remaining Portion of Site No.2 Belonging To Shashishekar M Wali; West: Site No.1; North: Private Property; South: Road. Schedule 'B' Property/All That Piece And Parcel Of Eastern Portion Of The Property Bearing Site No.2, Assessment No.9/2, BBMP Khata No.9/2/2, Byatrayanapura Cmc Khata No.1234/9/2/2 Situated At Thindlu Village, Yelahanka Hobli, Bangalore North Taluk, Measuring: 1) East To West : 6'6" And North To South: 42'11" - 279.00 Sq. Ft. 2) East To West: 18'6"+18'11"2 And North To South : 71'6"+67'2.- 1296.00 Sq. Ft. Total - 1575.00 Sq. Ft. Bounded On: East: Site No.3; West: Remaining Portion Of Site No.2 Belonging To Smt. Hema; North: Private Property; South: Road. Schedule 'C' Property Apartment Known As JBK Ganapathi, Flat No.002, New Bbmp Khata No.1234/9/2/GF-002, Situated On The Ground Floor of The Building Already Constructed On Schedule 'A' And 'B' Properties Having Super Built Up Area Measuring 1125 Sq. Ft. Including One Car Parking Space In The Stilt Floor of The Buildingand Bounded On: East : Lift And Staircase West: Open To Sky North: Open To Sky South: Flat 001 Schedule 'D' Property 275 Sq. Ft. Undivided Share, Right, Interest, Etc In Schedule 'A' And 'B' Properties Above, Together With All Rights Attached Thereto./ Date of Symbolic Possession on/ 12/03/2026.	17.12.2025 Rs. 51,84,993.00/-	Bangalore

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: March 18, 2026
Place: Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.



Mukta Swadhyaya Peetham
(Institute of Open and Distance Education)



Central Sanskrit University
86-57, Institutional Area, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058

Adv. No.-02/2025-2026

Dated: 18/03/2026

Notification

Applications are invited for various contractual positions of Assistant Professors (Contract) in various Sanskrit subjects. Sanskrit Language teacher and Technical staff (Technical Managers, Technical Assistants, Senior Consultant). Apply before 27-03-2026. Visit website (https://www.sanskrit.nic.in/ and https://www.msp.ac.in/) for more details.

cbc 21212/12/0006/2526

-Director

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Rakesh S/o** Kanta Prasad **R/o** G-3/35 Sundar Nagri Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 581/2014 U/s 363 IPC PS: Nand Nagari Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rakesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rakesh** accused of **FIR No. 581/2014 U/s 363 IPC PS: Nand Nagari Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Deepakshi Rana
JMFC-03, Room No. 19
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/3395/NE/2026
(Court Matter)



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in> Please ensure to check these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **11/S.M.-Jai-O.A./E.T./2025-26**, M/o STP (Two years Maintenance of Irrigation line from UGR, STP-50 to J-Block, Sector 41 and Golf Course to Botanical Garden), Noida. **Cost Rs. 29.95 Lac**

Which can be uploaded by **date: 31.03.2026 upto 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on **date:-01.04.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

(B)

1. **23/S.M.(Jal)-I/E.T./2025-26**, Strengthening of Sewerage (S/F of 600 mm dia Reflex valve on Raising the Manhole of SPS and Allied Civil Work SPS-66), Noida. **Cost Rs. 15.38 Lacs**

2. **24/S.M.(Jal)-I/E.T./2025-26**, M/o Sewerage (Repairing of Damaged Sewer and Water line Different Places Community Health Center in Bhangel Sector-110) Noida. **Cost Rs. 26.75 Lacs**

Which can be uploaded by **date:- 24.03.2026 upto 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on **date: 25.03.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

Office: General Manager (Jal)
Sector - 5 Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	35 (A,B,C,D,E,F,G) /25-26/WE
Name of work with its location	(A). AMC for two years of commercial RO 3000 Ltr/hrs. at RPSP Block A Electric workshop printing press and 2 nos 500 Ltrs/Hr. capacity at RPF & RPSP and other different capacity RO in the section of SSE/W/Punjab Bagh under ADEN-II. & Maintenance of RO plant cap. 3000 LPH, softening plant, Chlorine dosing pump & filtration plant at P.K. Road in the section of SSE/W/PG under ADEN-I.
	(B). Supply of Potable water through tankers under DEN/E-I.
	(C). Supply of Potable water through tankers under DEN/E-II.
	(D). Annual maintenance of Lawn/Parks & hedge in the S/o SSE/Hort./NDLS under ADEN/Hort./NDLS.
	(E). Supply & maintenance of Indoor well developed ornamental potted plants, average ht. 1' to 5' on hire basis at CRS Office, Northern Circle, CRIS Complex, Chanakypuri, New Delhi in the S/o SSE/Hort./SOJ (for two years) and in HQ office Baroda House in the S/o SSE/Hort./BH and in DRM office New Delhi, CPM/GSU, Control Room in DRM office New Delhi, C/CRS office, Railway Board Media Centre, TA Building and at NRCH main Administrative building in the S/o SSE/Hort./NDLS under ADEN/Hort./NDLS.
	(F). Annual Supply of Horticulture Material in the S/o SSE/Hort./BH & IE/Hort./HNZM under ADEN/Hort./NDLS.
	(G). Annual Supply of Horticulture Material in the S/o SSE/Hort./SPM & SSE/Hort./SOJ under ADEN/Hort./NDLS.
	(A) 10996399.26 (B) 17499946.54 (C) 17499946.54 (D) 7499999.00 (E) 29120546.40 (F) 1496440.65 (G) 9999938.27
	(A) 1519900.00 (B) 3500000.00 (C) 3500000.00 (D) 1500000.00 (E) 582400.00 (F) 149900.00 (G) 200000.00
	(A) 24 Months (B) 12 Months (C) 12 Months (D) 16 Months (E) 24 Months (F) 12 Months (G) 12 Months
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Closing date of tender on 07.04.2026 at 15.00 hrs.
Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in .

No: 128-W/269/O.E./T/NIT No. 35 (A,B,C,D,E,F,G) /25-26/WE Dated:-16.03.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 896/2026



केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
भारत सर्वोच्च का उद्गम

सिंडिकेट सिंडिकेट Syndicate

RO WEST, VIKASPURI, BRANCH

ANNEXURE - 10

POSSESSION NOTICE [SECTION 13(4)]

(For Immovable property)

Whereas: The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of the Canara Bank under Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (Act 54 of 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "the Act") and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued a Demand Notice dated calling upon the borrower **MRS. POONAM SHARMA (BORROWER)** and Mr. PARVEEN SHARMA (CO BORROWER) to repay the amount mentioned in the notice, being Rs. (Rupees: Rs 49,04,614.10 (Forty-Nine Lakhs Four Thousand Six Hundred Fourteen & Paise Ten Only) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him / her under section 13 (4) of the said Act, read with Rule 8 & 9 of the said Rule on this 17th day of MARCH of the year 2026.

The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Canara Bank for an amount of Rs. **Rs 49,04,614.10 (Forty-Nine Lakhs Four Thousand Six Hundred Fourteen & Paise Ten Only)** and interest thereon w.e.f.05.01.2026.

The borrower's attention is invited to the provisions of Section 13 (8) of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTY

All the part & parcel of the Residential property at Entire First Floor (without Roof/Terrace Rights), Part of Freehold Built Up property bearing No. 70, Pocket -9, Sector-22, Situated in the layout plan of Rohini Residential Scheme, Rohini, Delhi-110086 Measuring:- 90.00 sq. mtr.

Boundaries:- (As per Sale Deed)
East:- Plot No. 71 **West:-** Plot No. 69
North:- Service Lane **South:-** Entry

Place : Delhi **Authorised Officer,**
Date: 17.03.2026 **Canara Bank**



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 225

Date: 17/03/2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Vyasi Dam, Juddo, Dakpathar UJVN Ltd., invites sealed tender from interested parties. Summary of tender is given below:

Tender No.17/EE(E&M)/Vyasi Dam/2025-26

Name of work/supply/services etc. Annual Sweeping, cleaning, up keeping & Sanitization work of Vyasi Dam, Juddo Dist-Dehradun

Estimated cost -Rs. 23,00,000.00 only + GST

Date of availability of bid document on website:- 17.03.2026 at 15:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of tender:- 06.04.2026 up to 16.00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit www.ujvn.com

Executive Engineer(E&M)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

IN THE COURT OF HON'BLE
JUNIOR CIVIL JUDGE, CUM
XVII ADDL JUDICIAL
MAGISTRATE OF FIRST
CLASS R.R.DISTRICT:
AT: Maheshwaram
O.S.No. 43 OF 2026

BETWEEN:
Anup Pal, S/o. Late Sohanlal Pal, Aged 58 yrs, Occ: Business, R/o. 143, Prayag Apartments, Near Dharamshila Cancer Hospital, VTC: Vasundhra Enclave, District: East Delhi-110 096. ...PLAINTIFF
AND
1. The Thasildhar, Kandukur Mandal, Ranga Reddy District. 2.ALL CONCERNED
...DEFENDANTS

Please take notice that the above suit is filed for declaration to declare the plaintiff has legal heirs of Late Kamla Pal and consequently declared the Plaintiff as absolute owner of the suit schedule property. The suit is posted to 24-03-2026 for appearance if any person or persons having any objection/claims kindly appear either in person or through an advocate in the above Court at 10-30 a.m. on the above said date, as otherwise the matter will be decided on merits.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY
All that piece and parcel of open plot of land bearing plot No.12, admeasuring 200 sq.yds, in Sy.No. 27, 28, 29, 35 and 36, situated at Meerkhanpet village and GP, Kandukur Mandal, R.R.Dist., and bounded by:North:Plot no.11, South :Plot no.13, East:Plot no.21 West: 33' wide Road.

// By Order of Court//
T. ASHOK ADVOCATE
Off cum Res:
H.No. 7-32/1, Sai nagar Colony, Pedda Amberpet, Hayathnagar, R.R. District. Cell: 9848267060



WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

No.TKD-03-2026 & TKD-04-2026, Date: 13/03/2026

Sr. Divisional Electric Engineer/TRS/ Electric Loco Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-44, acting for and on behalf of The president of India. invites E-Tenders against the following Tenders, with the closing date 06/04/2026. Bidders will be able to submit their original/ revised bids up closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored..

TENDER/BID NO.-TKD-03-2026, NAME OF WORK AND STATION- "Repair and maintenance of roof mounted CAB AC units during minor and major inspection schedule of 3-phase locomotives at Electric Loco Shed Tughlakabad for a period of 02 years at Electric Loco-Shed Tughlakabad., QTY.-As per Schedule of Rates, **ESTIMATED COST (IN RS.)-1,33,83,089.61/-, COST OF TENDER FORM (IN RS.)- NIL, MONEY (IN RS.) EARNEST-2,16,900/-, COMPLETION PERIOD - 24 Months, LAST DT. & TIME OF SUBMISSION OF TENDER- 06.04.2026 at. 15:30 Hrs., TENDER/BID NO.-TKD-04-2026, NAME OF WORK AND STATION-** "Repair/Reconditioning Auxiliary Motors of 03 Phase Locomotives at ELSTKD for a period of 02 years., QTY.- As per Schedule of Rates, **ESTIMATED COST (IN RS.)-1,03,92,910.65/-, COST OF TENDER FORM (IN RS.)- NIL, MONEY (IN RS.) EARNEST-2,02,000/-, COMPLETION PERIOD - 24 Months, LAST DT. & TIME OF SUBMISSION OF TENDER- 06.04.2026 at. 15:30 Hrs., Note:- 1. E-Tender document and details of E-tender will be available on website www.ireps.gov.in Portal., 2. Manual offer will not be acceptable for this E-Tender, in case manual offer received then offer will not be considered., 3. For any correction in this tender, corrigendum will be up-loaded on website, which may be seen up-to the date of tender opening., 4. Tenderer must have class-III, digital signature certificate and will have to register on IREPS portal.**

Sd/-
For Sr. Div. Elct. Engg. (TRS),
Electrical Loco Shed, WCR, Tughlakabad, New Delhi

सचिव भारत अविमान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर



Muthoot Homefin

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office: Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 026

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the "said Borrower"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below.

In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to MHIL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest at 2% p.m. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to MHIL by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor/ Loan Account No./Branch	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Date of Demand Notice	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1.	Akhilesh Kumar Sharma/ Sudha Devi/ 056-05600204/ GHA-NHL-000694/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 4,24,515/- Rupees Four Lakh Twenty Four Thousand Five Hundred Fifteen Only & Rs. 3,90,136/- Rupees Three Lakh Ninety Thousand One Hundred Thirty Six Only.	28-Feb-2026	House Admeasuring 41.80 Sqm, In Khasra No:32, Adarsh Colony, Village Dundahera, Pargana Loni, Tehsil And Distt. Ghaziabad, Up. North- House Of Geeta W/o Yogesh, South- House Of Sunita Devi (Mother Of Prashant), East-Road 13 Feet, West-others Property
2.	Arun Kumar/ INDU DEVI/ 056-05600284/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 10,87,355/- Rupees Ten Lakh Eighty Seven Thousand Three Hundred Fifty Five Only.	28-Feb-2026	Unit No. 002, Ground Floor, Plot No. D-081, Pocket- D, Type-g, Kh. No. 785, Shouryapuram, Vill- Shahpur Bamnatha, Ghaziabad, U.P. North:9 M Wide Road; South: Building On Plot No D-66; East: Vacant Land Used As A Path As Of Now; West: Building On Plot No D-80; Building Plot No D-80; Path As Of Now
3.	Ashok Kumar/ Geeta Devi/ 058-05800254/ Noida	Rs. 4,40,882/- Rupees Four Lakh Forty Thousand Eight Hundred Eighty Two Only.	28-Feb-2026	Area Measuring 100 sq. yds., Plot No. B-54, Khasra No. 355, Situated at Dream, City Village Dhoomanikpur, Tehsil Dadri., Disst., Gautam Budh, Nagar, U.P. East: Road 20 ft., West: Plot No. B-27, North: Plot No. B-55, South: Plot No. B-53.
4.	Bharat Lal Pandey/ Surya Prakash Pandey/ 056-05600305/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 7,82,679/- Rupees Seven Lakh Eighty Two Thousand Six Hundred Seventy Nine Only.	28-Feb-2026	Flat No: FF-2, First Floor (2nd Floor As Per Site Observation), On Plot No K-17, Gali No 13, Khasra No 1472, Balaji Enclave, Village Raispur, Ghaziabad Up North: Building On Plot No K-16; South: Building On Plot No K-18; East: Other Property, West: 25 Ft Wide Road
5.	Chandra Sekhar Dalakoti/ Neeta Dalakoti/ 056-05600075/ Ghaziabad	Rs.10,71,814/-Rupees Ten Lakh Seventy One Thousand Eight Hundred Fourteen Only.	28-Feb-2026	House No. B-122 Krishna Enclave, Vill- Saini Sunpara, Sector-12, Kp-5, Tehsil Dadri, G.b Nagar North: House No. B-123 (dablu) ; South: Plot No. B-121; East: Road 18 Ft; West: Vacant Plot
6.	Krishna Avtar Singh/ Kishu Singh/ 05600046/ Ghaziabad	Rs.9,48,884/- Rupees Nine Lakh Forty Eight Thousand Eight Hundred Eighty Four Only.	28-Feb-2026	Vacant Residential Plot Of Land Area Measuring 99 Sq. Yds., I.e. 82.77 Sq. Mtrs., Out Of Total Area Measuring 1000 Sq. Yds., Khata No. 84, Khasra No. 87, Situated Vaka Village Illahabas Tehsil Dadri & Distt Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. East: Others Plot; West: Road 20 Ft.; North: Plot Of Jaiveer; South: Plot Of Vikash
7.	Prem Shankar Tiwari/ Alka/ DEL-HL-000728/ Delhi	Rs. 18,71,270/- Rupees Eighteen Lakh Seventy One Thousand Two Hundred Seventy Only.	28-Feb-2026	Built-Up Second Floor (without roof rights) of Property Bearing Pnt. No. 1337, Area Measuring 56 sq. yds., Out of Khasra No. 44/23 & 24, Situated in the Area of Village Burari, Delhi, Abadi Known as Gali No. 5, B-Block, Baba Colony, Burari Delhi- East : Other's Property, West: Other's Property, North:Other's Property, South: Road 14 ft. wide
8.	Rakesh Kumar/ Manju/ GHA-NHL-000703/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 5,35,489/- Rupees Five Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Four Hundred Eighty Nine Only.	28-Feb-2026	Commercial One Triangle Shop, Area Measuring 15.5 Sq.yds., I.e. 3.01 Acre, Situated in Khata No.74, Khasra No.2303min Out Of Total Area Measuring 2,9160 Hectare, Situated At Hapur Mohalla Bhinnagar, Hapur (middle Portion Of Govt. Hospital To Railway Crossing Road), Tehsil And Distt. Hapur, Hereinafter The Said Property). East-Plot Of Jain Sahab, West-Shop Of Mr. Subhash Chand, North-road Garh Delhi Road, South-other House.
9.	Ravindra Ravindra/ Shivi/ NOI-NHL-000942/ NOI-NHL-001000/ Noida	Rs. 11,29,713.7/- Rupees Eleven Lakh Twenty Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Thirteen And Paise Seventy Only & Rs. 8,14,507.7/- Rupees Eight Lakh Fourteen Thousand Five Hundred Seventy And Paise Seventy Only.	28-Feb-2026	Residential House no. 90, area measuring 168.06 Sq. Meters, out of Khasra no. 1914, Situated in the village Pabla Begambabad, Pargana Bagpat, Tehsil & Distt. Bagpat, U.P. . Boundaries :-North- Plot of First Party South- Rasta 22 Ft. Wide.East-Rajkije Degree Collage. West- Rasta 20 Feet wide.
10.	Sandeep Drall/ Saroj/ DEL-HL-000572/ DEL-NHL-000562/ Delhi	Rs. 32,13,454/- Rupees Thirty Two Lakh Thirteen Thousand Four Hundred Fifty Four Only & Rs. 12,77,957/- Rupees Twelve Lakh Seventy Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Seven Only.	28-Feb-2026	H No 315, Village Neelwal, Po Tikri Kalan, Delhi-110041 (respected Father Of The Releasees No 1 And 2 And Husband Of The Releasee) Was The Owner Of 1/12th Share In Plot Bearing Khata / Khatauni No 70/107, Comprised In Khara No 207 (1-14), 208 (0-10), 210 (0-12) And 210/L (0-02), I.e. 243 Sq. Yds. Approx., On Eastern Side Corner, Situated Within The Extended Lal Dora Abadi Of Village Neelwal, Delhi-110041 As Per Revenue Records, Delhi / As Per Khata/khatauni Which Is Bounded As Under:- East: Road 11 1/2 Feet Wide, West:other's Property Related To Sh Braham Singh, North:other's Property Related To Sh Raj Kapoor, South : Road 10 Feet Wide
11.	Raghendra Pratap Singh/ Raghav Pratap Singh/ Veena Devi/ 058-05800879/ NOI-NHL-000889/ Noida	Rs. 18,18,479/- Rupees Eighteen Lakh Eighteen Thousand Four Hundred Seventy Nine Only & Rs. 4,69,680/- Rupees Four Lakh Sixty Nine Thousand Six Hundred Eighty Only.	28-Feb-2026	Freehold Residential house (Villa) No. D-3, area measuring 75 sq. yds., at Sunrise Villa built on Plot No. D-3, Block-D, out of Khasra No. 113, situated at Shiv Adarsh Colony, Village Dundaheda, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & Distt. Ghaziabad, U.P. EAST: Plot of other, NORTH: Plot No. D-2, WEST:Rasta 20 ft. wide, SOUTH: Plot No. D-2
12.	Akhilash Akhilash/ Subhash/ Anil/ Sureshshavri/ DEL-NHL-000599/ Delhi	Rs.14,86,196/-Rupees Fourteen Lakh Eighty Six Thousand One Hundred Ninety Six Only.	28-Feb-2026	Residential house area measuring 204 sq. yards situated at Abadi in village Khekada tehsil & district Baghatp U.P East- Khet of Shyamveer, West: House Of Palturam, North- House of Bhude, South- Rasta 15 feet wide
13.	Rahul/ Chet Ram/ Kirti/ Kitabo Devi/ 063-06300036/ REWARI	Rs.4,39,339/-Rupees Four Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Three Hundred Thirty Nine Only.	28-Feb-2026	Residential Property Bearing House Tax No. 6744 Measuring 70 Sq. Yards Situated At Gudiya Saraye, Rewari, Tehsil And District Rewari, Which May Be Bounded As Under East: Gali, North: House Of Khem Chand, West: House Of Khem Chand, South: Gali

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to MHIL as aforesaid, MHIL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences.

The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of MHIL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: March 18, 2026
Place: Ghaziabad, Gautam Budh Nagar, Delhi, Bagpat

Sd/-Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 226

Date: 17/03/2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

The office of Executive Engineer (Maint.), Vyasi Power Station, Dakpathar invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :

Tender No: 1. 21/EE(M)/Vyasi/2025-26 2. 25/EE(M)/Vyasi/2025-26

Name of work / Supply/Services:

1. Supply and application of coating material on Spiral casing inner surface, Stay Vane & Staying surface and Outlet pipe inner surface of one unit no. 01 of Vyasi Powerhouse.

2. Hiring of one no. 27 Seater Bus for one year on contract basis for transportation of staff of Vyasi Project, Hathiyari, Dehradun

Estimated cost: 1.Rs 72,69,120/- only + GST extra 2. Rs 44,50,000/- only + GST extra

Date of availability of bid document on website:- 17.03.2026 from 16:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of bids on website:- 07.04.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

The Dy.Chief Electrical Engineer (Const), Northern Railway, Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-tender for the following work:

1. Name of work and location	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) of Window Type and Split Type Air Conditioners, Storage Type Water Coolers, Refrigerators/Deep Freezers and Desert Coolers installed in various Construction Offices and Rest Houses in Delhi/New Delhi area and CAMC of 2 x 16 HP VRF Air Conditioning Plant installed at CAO/C Office Complex, Kashmiri Gate, Delhi
2. Completion period of the work	36 Months
3. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 50,92,960/-
4. Bid Security to be deposited	Rs. 1,01,900/-
5. Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender	Tenders may be uploaded upto 15:00 hrs on 08.04.2026 date on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in The bidders can participate in the e-tender, the tender will be opening of tender
6. Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document	The detailed e-tender notice is available on Northern Railway web site i.e. www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in and tender document is available on www.ireps.gov.in Above tenders document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 25.03.2026 to 08.04.2026. All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document. The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

No. Tender No. 17-Elect./DYCEE/CT/161 Dated: 16.03.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 890/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.PC/ 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Diwakar S/o** Brijbhushan **R/o** WZ-16, Ground Floor, **Ram Nagar Extn., Tilak Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No./CC No. 1368/2020 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Bhajanpura, Distt. North-East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Diwakar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Diwakar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Diwakar** of **FIR No./CC No. 1368/2020 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Bhajanpura, Distt. North-East, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **01.06.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order

Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate-First Class-01
Court No. 73, Distt. North-East
Karkardoom Courts, Delhi

DP/3292/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Shyam Babu, S/o.: Banwari Lal, R/o.: H. No. 272, Hastal Village, Tyagi Chaupal, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.482/2018 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Vikaspuri, West District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shyam Babu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shyam Babu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shyam Babu**, accused of **FIR No.482/2018 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC, P.S Vikaspuri, West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.04.2026**.

By Order, Rishabh Kapoor

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
South-West District, Court No.09,
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi.

DP/3287/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS



Salim Khan discharged from Mumbai hospital

Veteran screenwriter Salim Khan, hospitalised in Mumbai last month after suffering a brain haemorrhage, was discharged on Tuesday and taken home, sources said.

The 90-year-old, one half of the celebrated Salim-Javed duo, which scripted films such as 'Sholay', 'Deewar' and 'Don' with Javed Akhtar, was admitted to the ICU of Lilavati Hospital in Bandra on February 17.

A day after his admission, doctors at the hospital said Khan suffered a brain haemorrhage that had been tackled and he was put on ventilator support as a safeguard.

"He has been treated successfully. He was discharged from the hospital a while ago," a source told PTI on Tuesday.

Earlier, in the morning, Salim Khan's son, superstar Salman Khan, arrived at the hospital. His other children, including son Arbaaz Khan, daughters Alvira and Arpita and sons-in-law Atul Agnihotri and Aayush Sharma, had visited him regularly in the hospital. His long-time partner Akhtar had also visited him.

Other than 'Sholay', 'Deewar' and 'Don', Khan and Akhtar also penned 'Trishul', 'Zanjeer', 'Seeta Aur Geeta', 'Haathi Mere Saathi', 'Ya-



The screenwriter was hospitalised last month after suffering a brain haemorrhage

don Ki Baarat' and 'Mr India'.

Hailing from an affluent family in Indore, Salim Khan arrived in Mumbai in his 20s with dreams of stardom. He was good-looking and confident that he would make a mark in the industry as an actor, but that didn't happen. After struggling for close to a decade and getting confined to small roles in films, he changed lanes.

He worked as an assistant to Abrar Alvi and soon met Akhtar to form one of Hindi cinema's most formidable writing partnerships. They worked together on two dozen movies, with most of them achieving blockbuster status.

HRITHIK TEAMS UP WITH PRIME VIDEO FOR 'MESS'

The actor is producing the project alongside Eshaan Roshan and Rajesh A Krishnan

Streaming service Prime Video announced its new movie 'Mess', marking its second collaboration with actor Hrithik Roshan's production banner 'HRX Films'.

Directed by Rajesh A Krishnan, the film will follow a motley group of robbers, who, upon invading the family house of a man with OCD, slowly realise it's not the family but them who need to survive this night-long standoff, according to a press release.

Roshan is producing the project alongside Eshaan Roshan and Krishnan's 'Soda Films Lab'.

The streamer and 'HRX Films' announced their first collaboration 'Storm', a thriller series, in October last year. "Storm" marked the start of something special with 'Prime Video' and 'Mess' feels like a natural next step for us at 'HRX Films', Roshan said.



The film will follow a motley group of robbers, who invades the family house of a man with OCD

He added, "Rajesh brings a distinctive voice both as a producer and director, with a rare ability to blend comedy with compelling narratives. His creative vision for 'Mess' has been

extraordinary from the start. As production ramps up, Eshaan and I are beyond excited by the potential of this project. We believe this film will resonate with audiences who appreciate fresh, unconventional stories that push the boundaries of the genre."

Nikhil Madhok, Director and Head of 'Originals', Prime Video India, said 'Mess' has a 'refreshingly original premise' and a unique set of characters.

"A key marker of a good story is if it takes you by surprise and keeps you entertained throughout. With 'Mess', we have a story that not only does that but makes you laugh at every step," he said.

He added, "Hrithik and Eshaan, through 'HRX Films', bring a strong creative instinct and a genuine passion for storytelling and after 'Storm', we are delighted to deepen our partnership further with this film."

Hrithik's banner 'HRX Films' is a division of his father Rakesh Roshan's production house 'FilmKraft Productions', which has been behind the filmmaker's iconic movies such as 'Karan Arjun', 'Kaho Naa Pyaar Hai', 'Koi Mil Gaya' and 'Krrish'.

Sanjay Kapoor talks about working in 'Sankalp'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Amazon MX Player recently launched 'Sankalp', an intriguing socio-political thriller that also marks the much-awaited OTT debut of veteran actor Nana Patekar. A 'Jio Studios' presentation, this electrifying series is directed and produced by National Award-winning filmmaker Prakash Jha. The series explores the battle between an educator who controls the system through his bureaucratic protégés, diving into the themes of 'Shiksha', 'Samarpan' and 'Satta'.



'Sankalp' is the story of loyalty, ideology and influence.

The series boasts a powerhouse ensemble cast featuring Sanjay Kapoor, Mohammed Zeeshan Ayyub, Neeraj Kabi, Kubbra Sait and Kranti Prakash Jha, bringing to life a layered story that examines mentorship, loyalty and the dynamics of power.

Speaking about portraying Chief Minister Prashant Singh and reflecting on his admiration for working with Prakash Jha, Sanjay Kapoor said, "My role is that of the Chief Minister. Nana Ji's character begins the journey and then gets backstabbed. One of the reasons for that in the show is my character. When you watch it, you'll understand. Iss show ki jo sabse important baat thi, jab Prakash ji ne mujhe show ke liye bulaya aur kahani ka ek hissa sunaya... Mere liye toh wahi ek khushi ki baat thi ki Prakash ji considered me good enough to call me for this show and for me, that was enough. Jaise kehte hain angrezi mein bucket list hota hai kisi ke saath kaam karne ka, toh mere bucket list mein the... Prakash ji ko main jaise jaanta hoon, dekhta hoon... Socha nahi tha ki mujhe bhi finally mauka milega Prakash ji ke saath kaam karne ka. It's been an honour."

DHARMENDRA'S ABSENCE FROM OSCARS 'IN MEMORIAM' SEGMENT



'IT IS A SHAME'

The absence of veteran actor Dharmendra from the 'In Memoriam' segment at the 98th Academy Awards sparked criticism from several Indian celebrities, including his wife and actress Hema Malini and veteran star Shatrughan Sinha. On Monday, during the ceremony held at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles, the Academy paid tribute to several global film personalities who passed away over the past year, including Robert Redford, Rob Reiner and Diane Keaton, among others. However, the segment didn't mention the legendary Bollywood star, who has had a career spanning more than six decades.

Reacting to the omission, Hema Malini told 'Bollywood Hungama', "It is a shame, of course. A shame for them to have overlooked an actor who means so many things to so many people in many parts of the world. Dharam ji was known and recognised everywhere."

She further added, "He never got too many awards during his lifetime. Why should he care about the Oscars? Both of us were always happy to be loved in our country. But awards always eluded him. Even I didn't receive awards for some of my best performances in 'Lal Patthar' and 'Meera'."

Veteran actor Shatrughan Sinha,

The absence of veteran actor Dharmendra from the 'In Memoriam' segment at the 98th Academy Awards sparked criticism from several Indian celebrities, including his wife and actress Hema Malini and veteran star Shatrughan Sinha

who worked with Dharmendra in films such as 'Blackmail' and 'Dost', told 'Variety', "It is a matter of shame for them if they don't honour Dilip Kumar, Lata Mangeshkar and now Dharmendra. Why does it matter to us? They are entrenched in our hearts forever."

Meanwhile, Dharmendra's daughter Esha Deol shared that the omission wouldn't have affected her father. "I don't think it would ever make a difference to Papa. His heart has always been far too big to worry about such things. For him, life was never about recognition or status - it was about love, kindness and the place he held in people's hearts," she said.

AGENCIES

Anil Kapoor confirms '24' S3 after a 10 year hiatus

The actor is currently riding high on the success of his action-drama 'Subedaar'

After a decade-long hiatus that left fans wondering if they'd ever see ATU Chief Jai Singh Rathod again, Anil Kapoor has officially confirmed that '24' Season 3 is in the works. The veteran actor, currently riding high on the success of his action-drama 'Subedaar', which released on March 5, 2026, took to 'X' to respond to a fan's plea for a revival of the series. With a simple but effective response, Kapoor reignited the countdown for the thriller.

Recently, a fan of Anil, who enjoyed his role in the series 'Subedaar', urged the actor to return with a new season of '24'. Responding to the plea, Anil confirmed on 'X' that it's in the works soon. "Coming with '24' soon," he posted alongside a punch emoji. For context, season 3 was slated for revival in 2018, but the project never launched on schedule.

Anil Kapoor led '24' Season 3, which aired in 2016, exactly a decade ago. The first season premiered on TV in 2013. The series follows ATU chief Jai Singh Rathod as he tackles a massive threat with just 24 hours



A fan of Anil urged the actor to return with a new season of '24'

to resolve it. Taken from the Hollywood show, '24' season 2 has Jai Singh Rathod in rehab after his fight with alcohol. He must stop terror leader Roshan Sherchan (Ashish Vidyarthi) from spreading a deadly virus in Mumbai. Like always, Jai has just 24

hours to do it.

Directed by Abhinav Deol, the series also starred Sakshi Tanwar as Jai's boss, Mallika Sen, Surveen Chawla as his lover Maya and Sikander Kher as Haroon Sherchan. Neil Bhoopalam returned as Aditya Singhania, now the nation's Prime Minister.

While only Kapoor is confirmed, fans are hoping for the return of Sakshi Tanwar, Sikander Kher and Neil Bhoopalam, who played the Prime Minister in Season 2. Abhinav Deo, who directed the first two seasons, expressed interest in the past. While no release date is set, the 'soon' suggests pre-production is likely underway.

AGENCIES

